

Umm Al-Qura University

College of Computing

Department of Software Engineering

BSc in Human–Computer Interaction

Graduation Project 1 (HCI3502T)

Semester 2, 1447H



Graduation Project 1 (Laylah Platform)

Section (6)

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Section 1 – Problem Statement & Objectives

Background

Context

Planning a wedding is a complex, multi-step process that requires coordination among multiple vendors, including venues, catering, decorations, photography, and entertainment. Traditionally, users rely on physical visits, scattered social media accounts, and manual price comparisons. This fragmented process increases effort, time consumption, and decision-making stress.

Domain

This project operates within the domain of digital wedding planning and event management platforms, focusing on improving User Experience (UX) and Information Architecture (IA). The system aims to enhance usability, efficiency, pricing transparency, and structured navigation.

Target Users

The platform targets individuals and families involved in wedding planning in Saudi Arabia, including:

- Family decision-makers are organizing weddings for their children.
- First-time engaged couples who require structured guidance.
- Budget-conscious planners who compare vendors carefully.

Although these users differ in experience levels and planning styles, they share common needs for clarity, transparency, efficiency, and reduced cognitive load during the wedding planning process.

Problem Definition

Main Problem

Individuals and families planning weddings struggle with cognitive overload, unclear pricing transparency, and inefficient vendor comparison due to fragmented information architecture and poorly designed digital platforms.

Research Evidence

Based on preliminary research, including analysis of wedding websites, mobile apps, and user questionnaires and interviews, several recurring issues were identified. Participants reported frustration with hidden pricing, scattered vendor information, difficulty comparing options, and a lack of structured guidance when planning weddings. These findings indicate a clear need to improve Information Architecture (IA) to better organize content, increase clarity, and reduce cognitive load. Making information easier to find and understand. In addition, improving usability is important to simplify navigation, make vendor comparison faster, and create a smoother and more comfortable planning experience for users.

Research Sources

- **User Questionnaires**

- Primary data was collected through structured user questionnaires targeting individuals involved in wedding planning. The survey aimed to identify users' needs, pain points, and expectations regarding digital wedding platforms. The responses were organized and analyzed to extract key insights related to pricing transparency, vendor comparison, and booking efficiency.

All data was documented in the following spreadsheet:

(https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1XWM0AcbTo2Nm9ccmQ3YbhpEquDZgtYIw/edit?usp=drive_link&ouid=110532697170731442285&rtpof=true&sd=true)

- **HCI Impact:**
 - From a Human–Computer Interaction (HCI) perspective, these issues negatively affect:
 - Usability – Complex navigation and unclear content hierarchy.
 - Efficiency – Long booking processes and repetitive manual comparisons.
 - User Satisfaction – Anxiety caused by hidden fees and uncertainty.
 - Decision Confidence – Lack of structured guidance for exploratory users.
 - outcomes: These issues result in wasted time, increased stress, and reduced trust in digital wedding planning solutions.

Objectives

- Improve information architecture to reduce cognitive load and enhance navigation clarity.
- Increase task efficiency by reducing booking completion time by at least 25% during usability testing.
- Enhance pricing transparency through structured comparison tools and clear cost breakdown displays.
- Achieve at least 90% task success rate for first-time users during prototype testing by optimizing the user journey.

Section 2 – Benchmarking (Nielsen Norman Heuristics)

Platform: Alam Zifaf

Heuristic	Rating (1-5)	Observation / Issue	Improvement Suggestion
Visibility of System Status	3	The system provides a confirmation page after submission but lacks loading indicators during the process and doesn't clarify the next steps.	Add a loading spinner during submission and clarify the next steps and expected response time for the user.
Match between System & Real World	2	The platform uses generic labels and categories that do not reflect the user's mental model for wedding planning.	Use terminology closer to the user's daily language and organize services based on actual wedding planning stages.
User Control & Freedom	2	Lack of clear control for critical actions; orders cannot be canceled after submission, and the login window lacks a clear close/cancel button.	Allow users to cancel or edit requests after submission, and add a visible "Close" or "Cancel" button to the login modal.
Consistency & Standards	3	General visual identity is consistent, but content layout and visual hierarchy vary between pages, causing confusion.	Enhance internal consistency by unifying content display styles, headings, and cards within a standardized Design System.
Error Prevention	3	Search suggestions reduce errors, but the system allows forms to be submitted with errors, showing alerts only after submission.	Implement real-time validation across all fields and disable the "Submit" button if errors are present.
Recognition Rather than Recall	2	Some input fields lack clear labels, and selected options are not visually highlighted, increasing memory load.	Add persistent field labels and visually highlight selected options to reduce cognitive load.

Flexibility & Efficiency of Use	3	Map-linked filtering provides an efficient way to explore services, but customization options and shortcuts are limited.	Add advanced filters and customization options or shortcuts to improve efficiency for experienced users.
Aesthetic & Minimalist Design	2	Design is visually comfortable, but some pages suffer from content clutter and poor highlighting of core elements.	Transform the interface into a "Web App" style rather than an "Article" style; reduce secondary elements and highlight "Book" and "Contact" buttons.
Help Users Recognize & Recover from Errors	2	Generic error messages appear after an action without sufficient explanation of the cause or how to fix it.	Provide specific error messages that explain the problem and suggest clear corrective steps.
Help & Documentation	3	Provides a categorized FAQ section and contact info, but content is limited and doesn't cover all user scenarios.	Expand FAQ content and link it to core tasks within the system for more comprehensive support.

Platform: Rafed

Heuristic	Rating (1-5)	Observation / Issue	Improvement Suggestion
Visibility of System Status	3	The system clearly shows the current stage (Cart, Info, Payment), but lacks status indicators during action execution.	Add clear status indicators during loading or payment processing, with immediate confirmation messages for success or failure.
Match between System & Real World	2	Service arrangement is unorganized and does not align with how users prioritize needs in reality.	Reorganize services logically based on user priority and actual needs.
User Control & Freedom	2	Users can delete items from the cart, but there is no clear "Cancel" or true "Undo" once steps have progressed.	Add "Back" and "Cancel" buttons at every step, with a confirmation prompt before exiting.
Consistency & Standards	3	Design is generally consistent in colors and buttons, but some headings and secondary text vary in size or phrasing.	Standardize the formatting of headings and secondary text to ensure a more cohesive experience.
Error Prevention	2	No alerts before errors occur (e.g., booking without selecting a service), and manual region entry increases error rates.	Add pre-submission alerts for bookings and replace manual text input with a dropdown menu for regions.
Recognition Rather than Recall	2	Navigation is simple but relies on memory as there are no summaries of current bookings during the process.	Add a sidebar or a persistent summary showing selected services, price, and current step.
Flexibility & Efficiency of Use	3	Lack of shortcuts or customization based on user preferences.	Add advanced filtering, quick search, and easy login features.
Aesthetic & Minimalist Design	3	Design is clean with good use of white	Improve visual hierarchy and highlight the most

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		space, but visual priorities (primary actions) are not always clear.	important elements on the page more clearly.
Help Users Recognize & Recover from Errors	2	Alerts like "Appointment Unavailable" appear but don't always explain why or guide the user on what to do next.	Display instructional error messages that explain the cause and suggest a clear corrective action.
Help & Documentation	3	Provides FAQs and contact methods, but help is not directly linked to the context of the task being performed.	Integrate brief contextual help within the booking steps to provide support exactly when needed.

Platform: Laylate Geer

Heuristic	Rating (1-5)	Observation / Issue	Improvement Suggestion
Visibility of System Status	2	Lacks clear indicators during actions like logging in or applying a discount; insufficient immediate confirmation.	Add loading indicators and clear confirmation messages during and after task execution.
Match between System & Real World	1	Contradictory information; e.g., a "Bentley" model listed for a car that is actually a "Mercedes" in the details.	Implement a data filter to prevent brand/model mismatches during service data entry.
User Control & Freedom	2	Navigation is possible, but lacks clear options to undo or cancel actions; the back button is too small.	Provide clear undo/cancel options and increase the size/visibility of the back button.
Consistency & Standards	2	Redundant buttons for "All Sections" and "All Services" on the same page, causing confusion.	Unify the navigation structure and merge similar buttons to reduce user distraction.
Error Prevention	2	Shows (0.0) ratings with empty stars for new services, giving an unintended negative impression.	Hide the star icon if there are no ratings and replace it with a "New" label to prevent misunderstanding.
Recognition Rather than Recall	3	The current section is hidden on some pages and the city is missing from some cards, forcing users to rely on memory.	Always display the current section name and add key info like "City" inside service cards.
Flexibility & Efficiency of Use	2	Only basic search and filters are provided, with no advanced features for frequent users.	Add customization options or shortcuts to facilitate faster task completion.
Aesthetic & Minimalist Design	2	Visual hierarchy is unclear on some pages; the back button is not visually prominent enough.	Enhance visual hierarchy by highlighting key navigation elements and increasing back button contrast/size.
Help Users Recognize &	2	Error messages are too generic and don't	Clearly identify the field causing the error and

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Recover from Errors		explain the cause or how to fix it precisely.	provide a direct example of how to correct it.
Help & Documentation	1	No help section or documentation; support is limited to a "Contact Us" form.	Add an FAQ section or a brief user guide with contextual help on key pages.

Section 3 – Personas, Journey Map, and Storyboard

Personas



Figure 1. User Persona Matrix provides a comprehensive overview of the target audience segments, including their demographics, core needs, and specific frustrations within the wedding planning ecosystem.

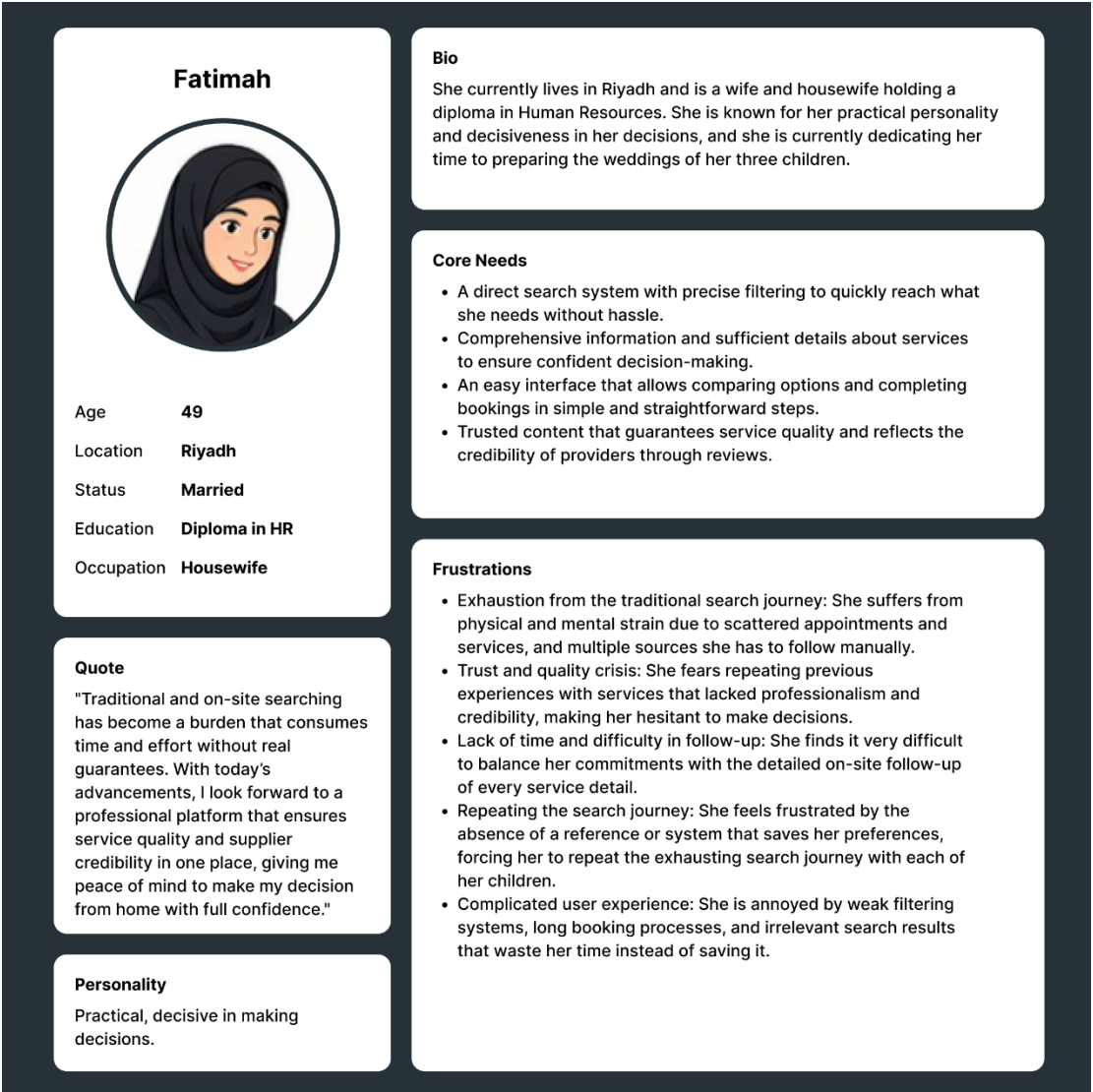


Figure 2. Detailed User Persona Profile for Fatimah, highlighting the specific pain points and core needs of a decision-maker seeking efficiency, trust, and comprehensive service integration

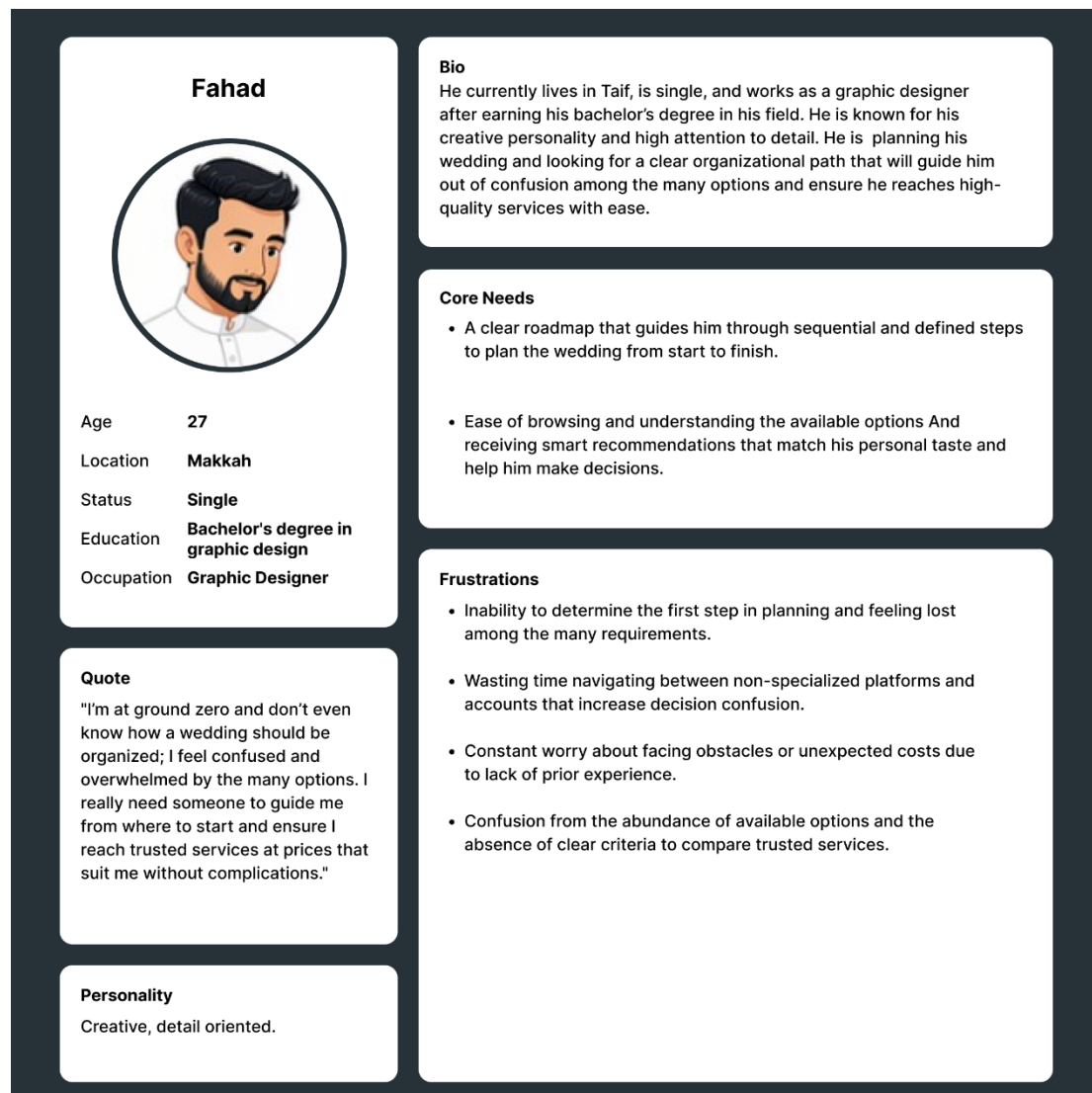


Figure 3. Detailed User Persona Profile for Fahad, emphasizing the needs of creative, tech-savvy users who require guided exploration and visual-driven decision support.

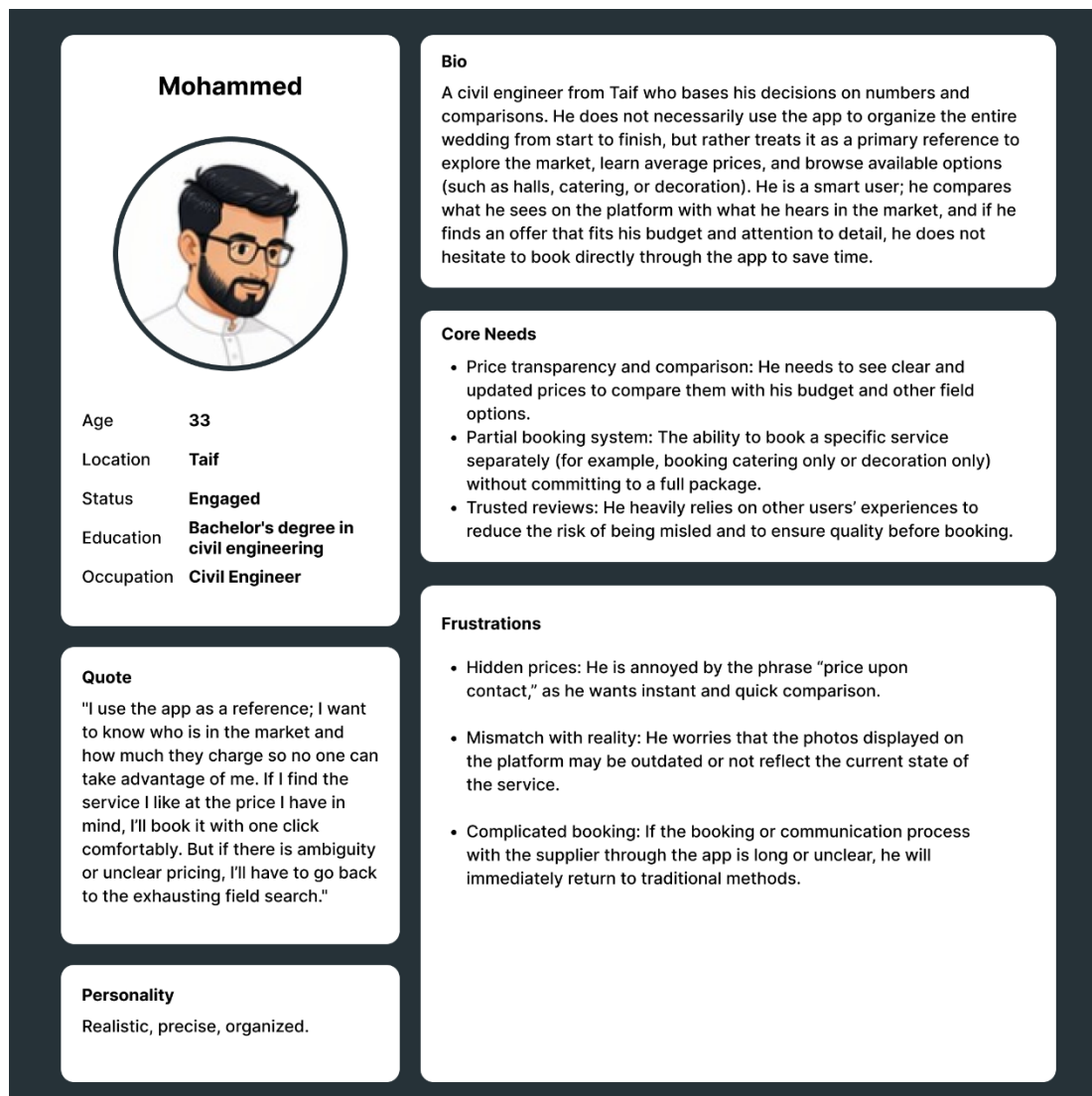


Figure 4. Detailed User Persona Profile for Mohammed, highlighting the priorities of analytical users who value price transparency, independent service booking, and data-driven trust.

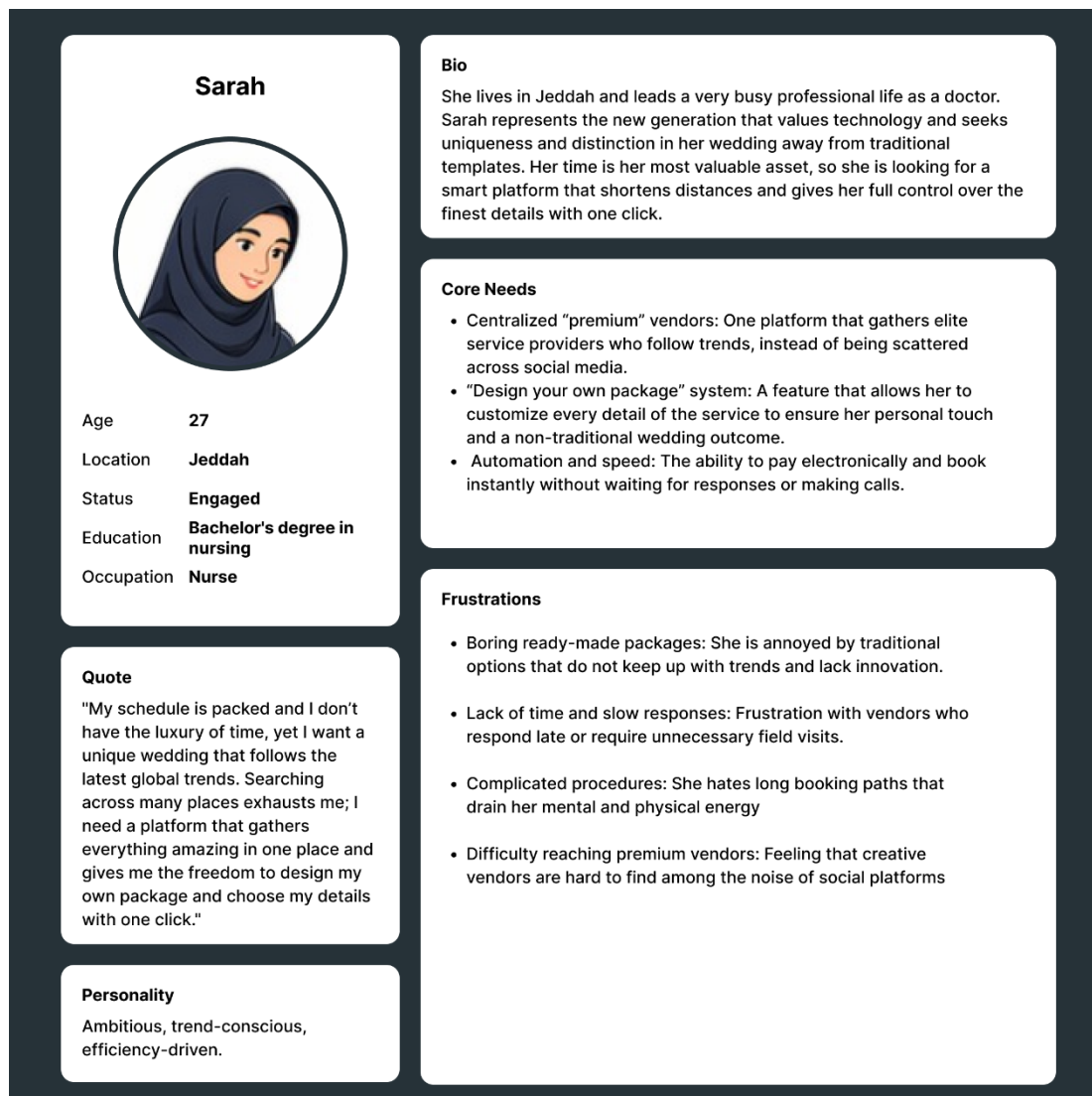


Figure 5. Detailed User Persona Profile for Sarah, illustrating the requirements of busy professionals who prioritize centralized premium vendors, automation, and exclusive customization.

Persona: Fatimah (Goal-Oriented User)

- **Name:** Fatimah.
- **Age:** 49.
- **Location:** Riyadh.
- **Personality:** Practical, decisive in making decisions.
- **Status:** Married.
- **Education:** Diploma in Human Resources in Riyadh.
- **Occupation:** Housewife.
- **Bio:** She currently lives in Riyadh and is a wife and housewife holding a diploma in Human Resources. She is known for her practical personality and decisiveness in her decisions, and she is currently dedicating her time to preparing the weddings of her three children.
- **Core Needs:**
 - A direct search system with precise filtering to quickly reach what she needs without hassle.
 - Comprehensive information and sufficient details about services to ensure confident decision-making.
 - An easy interface that allows comparing options and completing bookings in simple and straightforward steps.
 - Trusted content that guarantees service quality and reflects the credibility of providers through reviews.
- **Goals:**
 - To find all the services she wants with high quality.
 - To complete bookings in the shortest time possible.
 - To follow up on booking details from home.
- **Frustrations / Pain Points:**
 - Exhaustion from the traditional search journey: She suffers from physical and mental strain due to scattered appointments and services, and multiple sources she has to follow manually.
 - Trust and quality crisis: She fears repeating previous experiences with services that lacked professionalism and credibility, making her hesitant to make decisions.
 - Lack of time and difficulty in follow-up: She finds it very difficult to balance her commitments with the detailed on-site follow-up of every service detail.
 - Repeating the search journey: She feels frustrated by the absence of a reference or system that saves her preferences, forcing her to repeat the exhausting search journey with each of her children.

- Complicated user experience: She is annoyed by weak filtering systems, long booking processes, and irrelevant search results that waste her time instead of saving it.

- **Technology Behavior:**

- She has a moderate but effective level of knowledge; she keeps up with the latest tools and technologies that serve her needs. She has sufficient skill to search and access relevant information, enabling her to use technology independently to achieve her goals and accomplish her tasks successfully.

- **Quote:**

- "Traditional and on-site searching has become a burden that consumes time and effort without real guarantees. With today's advancements, I look forward to a professional platform that ensures service quality and supplier credibility in one place, giving me peace of mind to make my decision from home with full confidence."

Persona: Fahad (Exploratory User)

- **Name:** Fahad.
- **Age:** 27.
- **Location:** Makkah.
- **Personality:** Creative, detail oriented.
- **Status:** Single.
- **Education:** Bachelor's degree in graphic design in Makkah.
- **Occupation:** Graphic Designer.
- **Bio:** He currently lives in Makkah, is single, and works as a graphic designer after earning his bachelor's degree in his field. He is known for his creative personality and high attention to detail. He is currently planning his wedding and looking for a clear organizational path that will guide him out of confusion among the many options and ensure he reaches high-quality services with ease.
- **Core Needs:**
 - A clear roadmap that guides him through sequential and defined steps to plan the wedding from start to finish.
 - Ease of browsing and understanding the available options And receiving smart recommendations that match his personal taste and help him make decisions.
- **Goals:**
 - To gain a clear vision of how to organize the wedding and understand all services and requirements.
 - To organize the event details smartly and easily without complexity or wasting time and effort.
 - To access trusted services that combine high quality with prices that suit his budget.
 - To avoid confusion caused by random searching and multiple unverified sources.
- **Frustrations / Pain Points:**
 - Inability to determine the first step in planning and feeling lost among the many requirements.
 - Wasting time navigating between non-specialized platforms and accounts that increase decision confusion.
 - Constant worry about facing obstacles or unexpected costs due to lack of prior experience.
 - Confusion from the abundance of available options and the absence of clear criteria to compare trusted services.
- **Technology Behavior:**

- He has an advanced and highly technical knowledge level; he is an avid user who fully relies on applications to organize his design work and daily life. He values efficiency and innovative digital solutions that save him time and field effort, and he has the ability to compare technical tools to choose the most seamless and professional in performance.
- **Quote:**
 - "I'm at ground zero and don't even know how a wedding should be organized; I feel confused and overwhelmed by the many options. I really need someone to guide me from where to start and ensure I reach trusted services at prices that suit me without complications."

Persona: Mohammed (Selective Comparative User)

- **Name:** Mohammed.
- **Age:** 33.
- **Location:** Taif.
- **Personality:** Realistic, precise, organized.
- **Status:** Engaged.
- **Education:** Bachelor's degree in civil engineering in Taif.
- **Occupation:** Civil Engineer.
- **Bio:** A civil engineer from Taif who bases his decisions on numbers and comparisons. He does not necessarily use the app to organize the entire wedding from start to finish, but rather treats it as a primary reference to explore the market, learn average prices, and browse available options (such as halls, catering, or decoration). He is a smart user; he compares what he sees on the platform with what he hears in the market, and if he finds an offer that fits his budget and attention to detail, he does not hesitate to book directly through the app to save time.
- **Core Needs:**
 - Price transparency and comparison: He needs to see clear and updated prices to compare them with his budget and other field options.
 - Partial booking system: The ability to book a specific service separately (for example, booking catering only or decoration only) without committing to a full package.
 - Trusted reviews: He heavily relies on other users' experiences to reduce the risk of being misled and to ensure quality before booking.
- **Goals:**
 - Smart exploration: To form a complete view of wedding costs and available options in the area through his phone.
 - Seizing opportunities: To find suppliers who combine high quality and reasonable prices and book them immediately if the conditions suit him.
 - Reducing physical effort: To minimize random field visits, so he only goes for inspection to suppliers he already liked in the app.
 - Building a favorites list: To gather the best trusted options in one place for final decision-making.
- **Frustrations / Pain Points:**
 - Hidden prices: He is annoyed by the phrase “price upon contact,” as he wants instant and quick comparison.

- Mismatch with reality: He worries that the photos displayed on the platform may be outdated or not reflect the current state of the service.
- Complicated booking: If the booking or communication process with the supplier through the app is long or unclear, he will immediately return to traditional methods.
- **Technology Behavior:**
 - He treats the platform like a booking app; he logs in regularly to check new offers and prices. He is a utilitarian technology user; he does not care about spending time in the app as much as he cares about obtaining accurate and fast information. He trusts data and technical reviews and prefers platforms that give him the freedom to choose between full online booking or obtaining contact details for a final field visit before payment.
- **Quote:**
 - "I use the app as a reference; I want to know who is in the market and how much they charge so no one can take advantage of me. If I find the service I like at the price I have in mind, I'll book it with one click comfortably. But if there is ambiguity or unclear pricing, I'll have to go back to the exhausting field search."

Persona: Sarah (Busy User)

- **Name:** Sarah.
- **Age:** 27.
- **Location:** Jeddah.
- **Personality:** Ambitious, trend-conscious, efficiency-driven.
- **Status:** Engaged.
- **Education:** Bachelor's degree in nursing in Jeddah.
- **Occupation:** Nurse.
- **Bio:** She lives in Jeddah and leads a very busy professional life as a doctor. Sarah represents the new generation that values technology and seeks uniqueness and distinction in her wedding away from traditional templates. Her time is her most valuable asset, so she is looking for a smart platform that shortens distances and gives her full control over the finest details with one click.
- **Core Needs:**
 - Centralized “premium” vendors: One platform that gathers elite service providers who follow trends, instead of being scattered across social media.
 - “Design your own package” system: A feature that allows her to customize every detail of the service to ensure her personal touch and a non-traditional wedding outcome.
 - Automation and speed: The ability to pay electronically and book instantly without waiting for responses or making calls.
- **Goals:**
 - Designing a unique experience: To have a wedding that reflects her modern personality and follows the latest global trends.
 - Maximum time efficiency: To complete all planning and booking procedures in the shortest time possible to fit her busy medical schedule.
 - Avoiding traditional search: To access amazing services (cakes, invitations, halls) without exhausting manual searching.
- **Frustrations / Pain Points:**
 - Boring ready-made packages: She is annoyed by traditional options that do not keep up with trends and lack innovation.
 - Lack of time and slow responses: Frustration with vendors who respond late or require unnecessary field visits.

- Complicated procedures: She hates long booking paths that drain her mental and physical energy.
- Difficulty reaching premium vendors: Feeling that creative vendors are hard to find among the noise of social platforms.
- **Technology Behavior:**
 - Sarah is a smart user; she fully relies on digital tools to manage her life. She does not tolerate slow or complicated platforms and highly trusts digital reviews and peer recommendations. She leans toward full automation and prefers solutions that provide a comprehensive dashboard that eliminates manual follow-up.
- **Quote:**
 - "My schedule is packed and I don't have the luxury of time, yet I want a unique wedding that follows the latest global trends. Searching across many places exhausts me; I need a platform that gathers everything amazing in one place and gives me the freedom to design my own package and choose my details with one click."

Journey Map

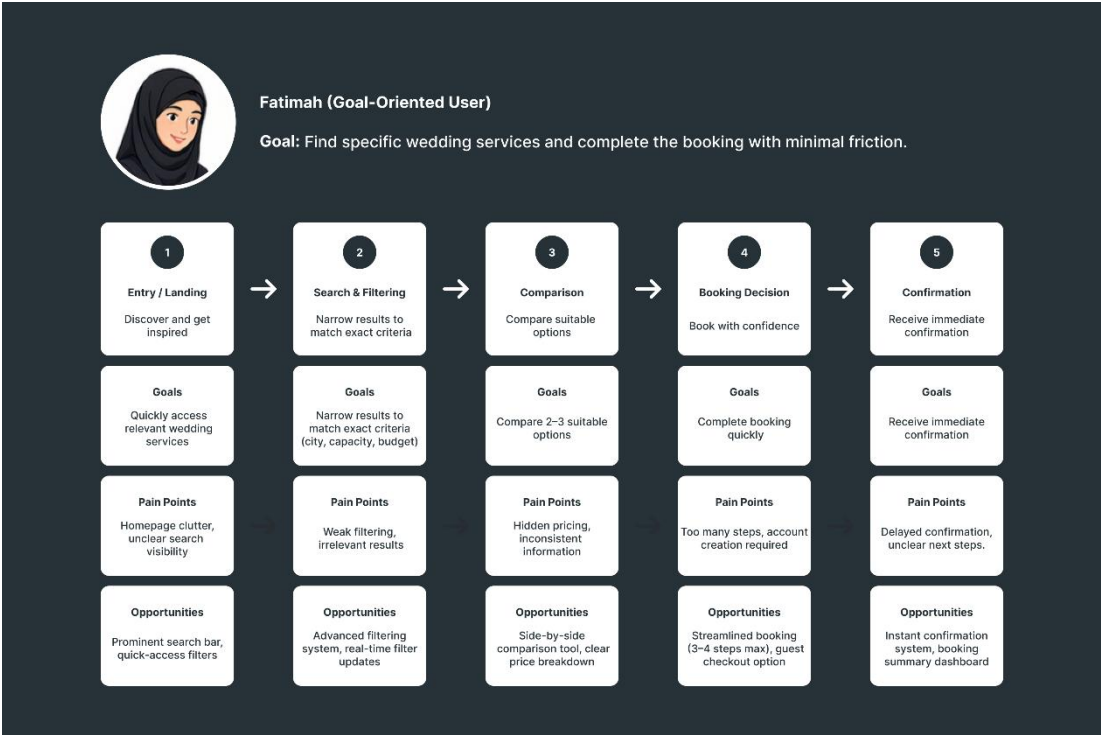


Figure 6. User Journey Map for Fatimah (Goal-Oriented User), illustrating the five key stages of the booking process: Entry, Search, Comparison, Decision, and Confirmation.

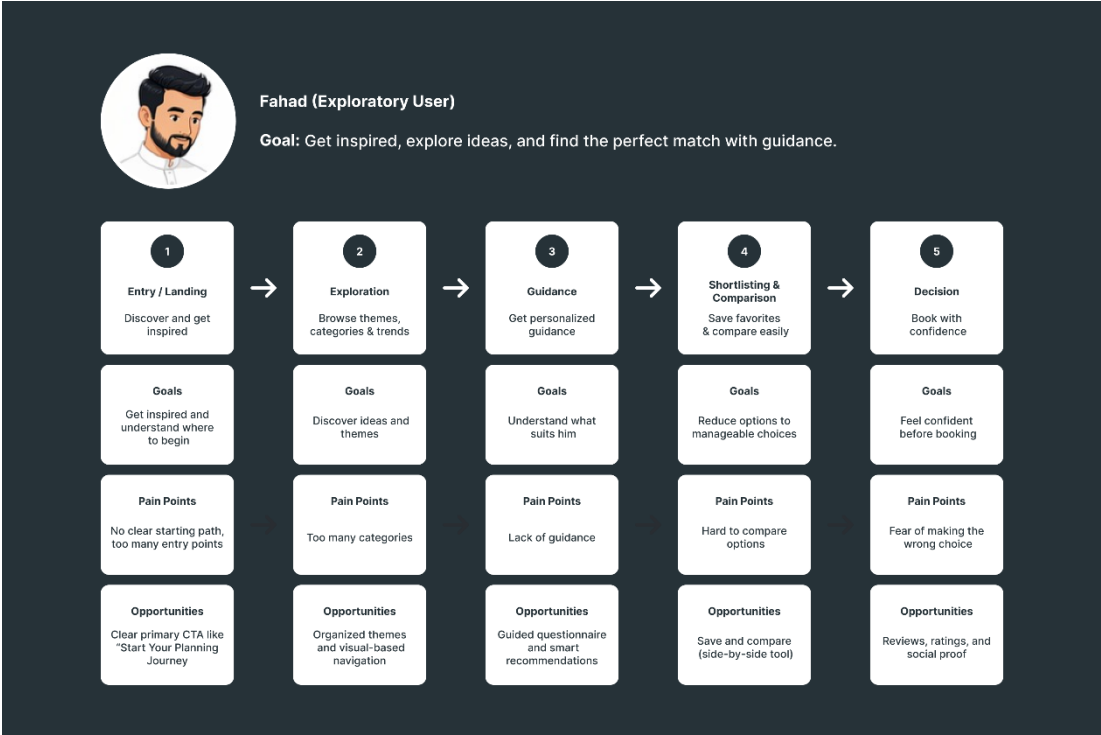


Figure 7. User Journey Map for Fahad (Exploratory User), outlining the stages of inspiration, guided exploration, and trust-building for a user seeking creative direction and assurance.

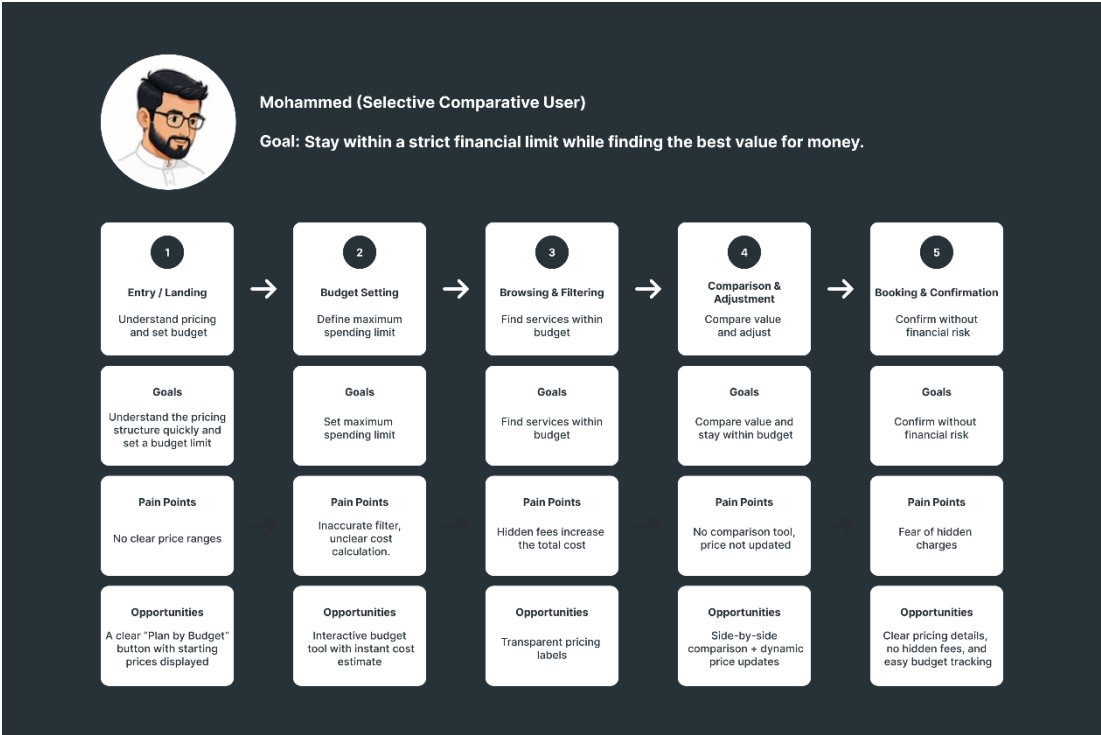


Figure 8. User Journey Map for Mohammed (Selective Comparative User), emphasizing the financial control lifecycle and the importance of price transparency and budget-driven decision-making.

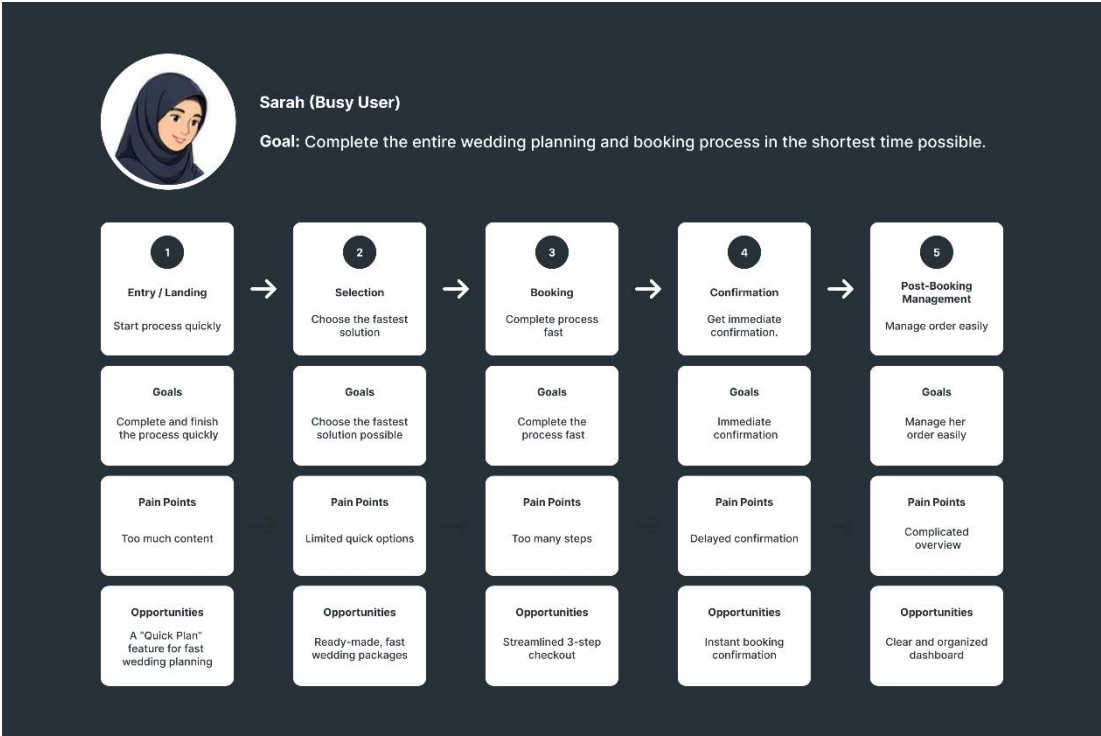


Figure 9. User Journey Map for Sarah (Busy User), focusing on the "Time-Efficiency" flow through ready-made solutions and streamlined post-booking management.

Fatimah (Goal-Oriented User)					
Stage	Goals	Actions	Pain Points	Emotions	Opportunities
1. Entry / Landing	Quickly access relevant wedding services	Enters the platform, uses the search bar immediately	Homepage clutter, unclear search visibility	Neutral, Slightly impatient	Prominent search bar, quick-access filters
2. Search & Filtering	Narrow results to match exact criteria	Applies filters (city, capacity, budget)	Weak filtering, irrelevant results	Frustrated if results are inaccurate	Advanced filtering system, real-time filter updates
3. Comparison	Compare 2–3 suitable options	Opens service pages, checks price & reviews	Hidden pricing, inconsistent information	Analytical but cautious	Side-by-side comparison tool, clear price breakdown
4. Booking Decision	Complete booking quickly	Clicks “Book Now,” fills required details	Too many steps, account creation required	Gets frustrated with delays	Streamlined booking (3–4 steps max), guest checkout option
5. Confirmation	Receive immediate confirmation	Waits for confirmation email or vendor response	Delayed confirmation, unclear next steps	Anxious, Relieved if confirmed	Instant confirmation system, booking summary dashboard

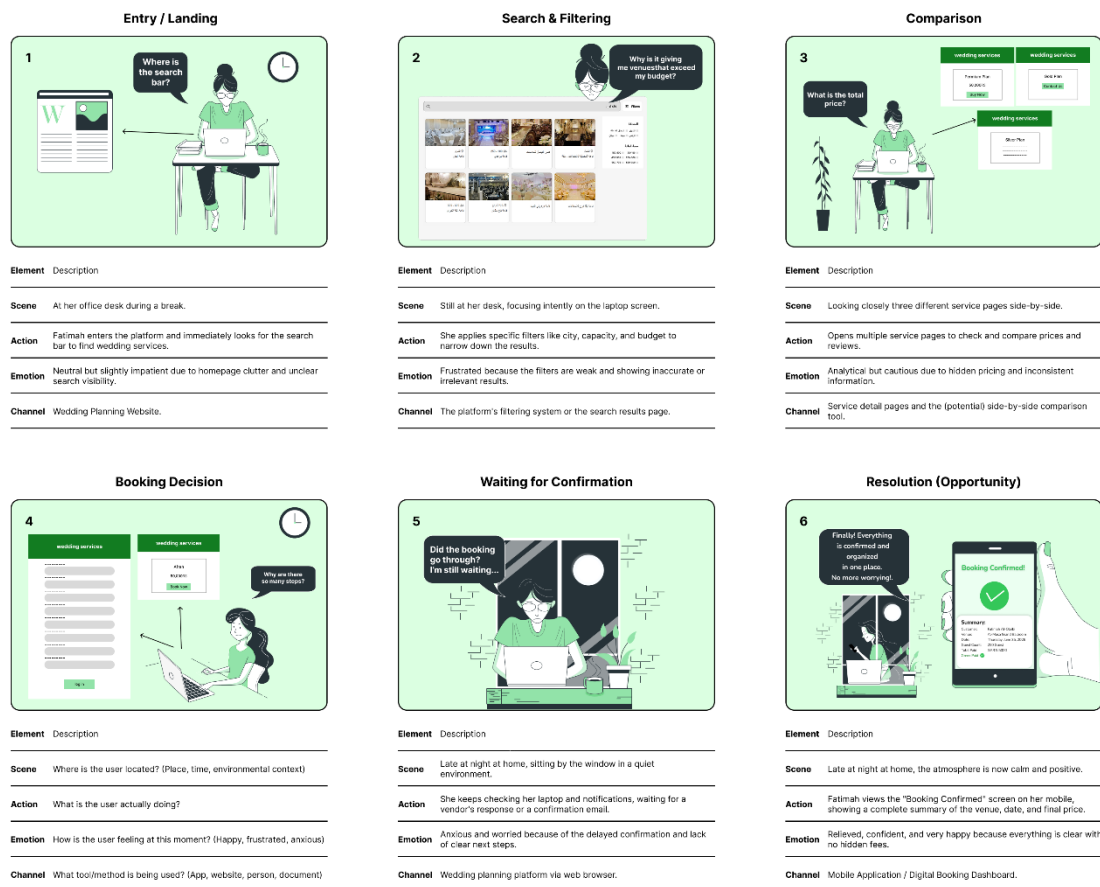
Fahad (Exploratory User)					
Stage	Goals	Actions	Pain Points	Emotions	Opportunities
1. Entry / Landing	Get inspired and understand where to begin	Browses homepage visuals, scans featured sections	No clear starting path, too many entry points	Curious, slightly overwhelmed	A clear primary call-to-action button, such as “Start Your Planning Journey.”
2. Exploration	Discover ideas & themes	Opens categories, views galleries and trending weddings	Too many categories	Overwhelmed	Organized themes, visual-based navigation
3. Guidance	Understand what suits him.	Uses filters and checks reviews	Lack of guidance	Confused	Guided questionnaire, smart recommendations
4. Shortlisting and Comparison	Reduce options to manageable choices	Saves favorites	Hard to compare	Hesitant	Save and compare feature such as Side-by-side comparison tool
5. Decision	Feel confident booking	Reviews details	Fear of wrong choice	Worried, but Confident	Reviews, ratings, social proof

Mohammed (Selective Comparative User)					
Stage	Goals	Actions	Pain Points	Emotions	Opportunities
1. Entry / Landing	Understand the pricing structure quickly and set a budget limit	Enters the platform, looks for pricing indicators within the price range	No clear price ranges	Cautious, alert	A clear “Plan by Budget” button with starting prices displayed
2. Budget Setting	Set maximum spending limit	Uses the budget filter or enters the total budget	Inaccurate filter, unclear cost calculation	Focused, doubtful	Interactive budget tool with instant cost estimate
3. Browsing and Filtering	Find services within budget	Checks available packages and prices	Hidden fees increase the total cost	Suspicious, Frustrated	Transparent pricing labels,
4. Comparison & Adjustment	Compare value and stay within budget	Compares services and adjusts package components	No comparison tool, price not updated	Analytical, slightly stressed	Side-by-side comparison + dynamic price updates
5. Booking & Confirmation	Confirm without financial risk	Reviews the final summary and completes payment	Fear of hidden charges	Anxious	Clear pricing details, no hidden fees, and easy budget tracking

Sarah (Busy User)					
Stage	Goals	Actions	Pain Points	Emotions	Opportunities
1. Entry / Landing	Complete and finish the process quickly	Searches as soon as he enters the platform	Too much content	Gets frustrated with delays	A “Quick Plan” feature for fast wedding planning
2. Selection	Choose a fast solution possible	Selects a ready-made package	Limited quick options	Neutral	Fast wedding packages
3. Booking	Complete the process fast	Fills details	Too many steps	Frustrated	3-step checkout
4. Confirmation	Immediate confirmation	Waits for response	Delayed confirmation	Anxious	Instant booking confirmation
5. Post-Booking Management	Manage her order easily	Views and reviews her booking details	Complicated overview	Overwhelmed	Clear and organized dashboard

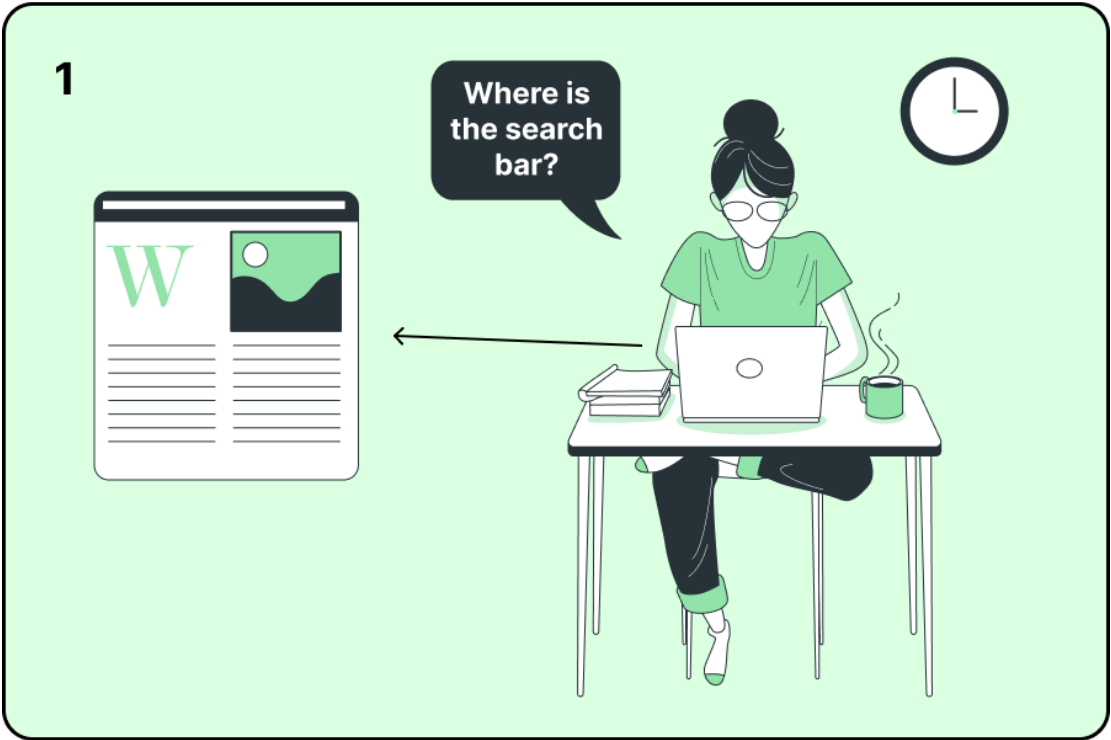
Storyboard

Figure 10. Complete storyboard illustrating the user's journey and challenges using



the Nielsen Norman format. Each frame includes Scene, Action, Emotion, and Channel.

Entry / Landing



Element Description

Scene At her office desk during a break.

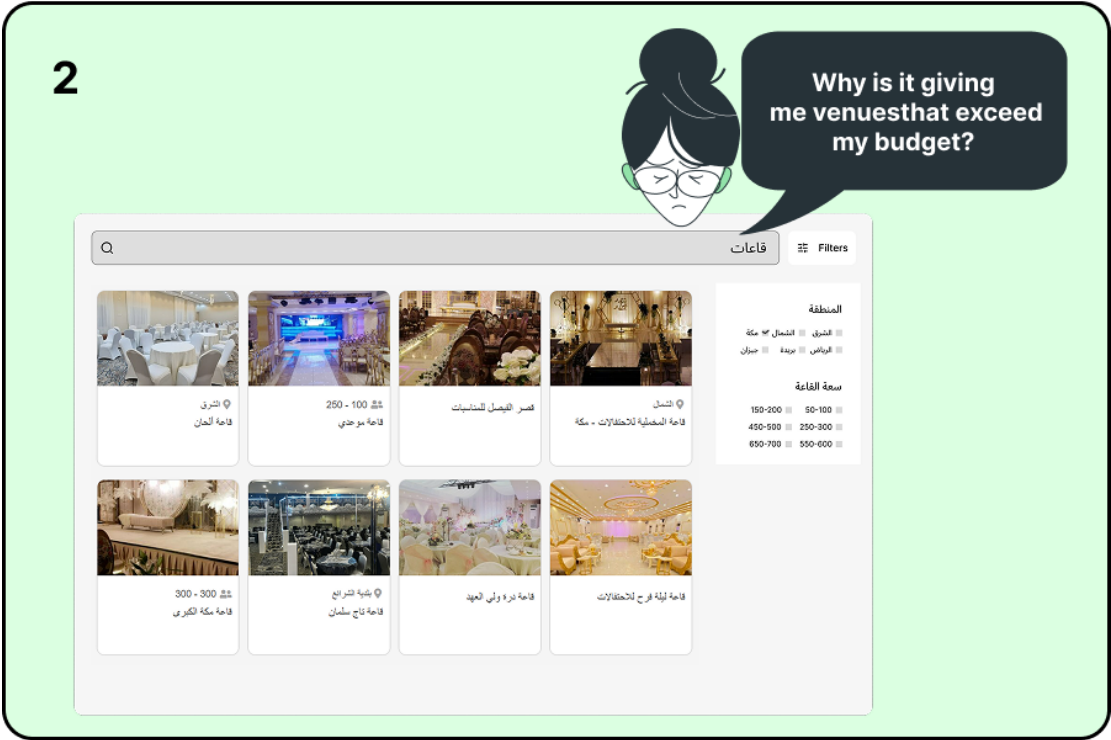
Action Fatimah enters the platform and immediately looks for the search bar to find wedding services.

Emotion Neutral but slightly impatient due to homepage clutter and unclear search visibility.

Channel Wedding Planning Website.

Figure 11. Storyboard Scene 1: Initial Landing and Navigation Discovery, depicting the user's initial encounter with platform clutter and the critical need for a prominent search interface.

Search & Filtering



Element	Description
Scene	Still at her desk, focusing intently on the laptop screen.
Action	She applies specific filters like city, capacity, and budget to narrow down the results.
Emotion	Frustrated because the filters are weak and showing inaccurate or irrelevant results.
Channel	The platform's filtering system or the search results page.

Figure 12. Storyboard Scene 2: Filter Inefficiency and Budget Misalignment, demonstrating the user's frustration with inaccurate search algorithms in traditional wedding planning tools.

Comparison



Element	Description
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Scene	Looking closely three different service pages side-by-side.
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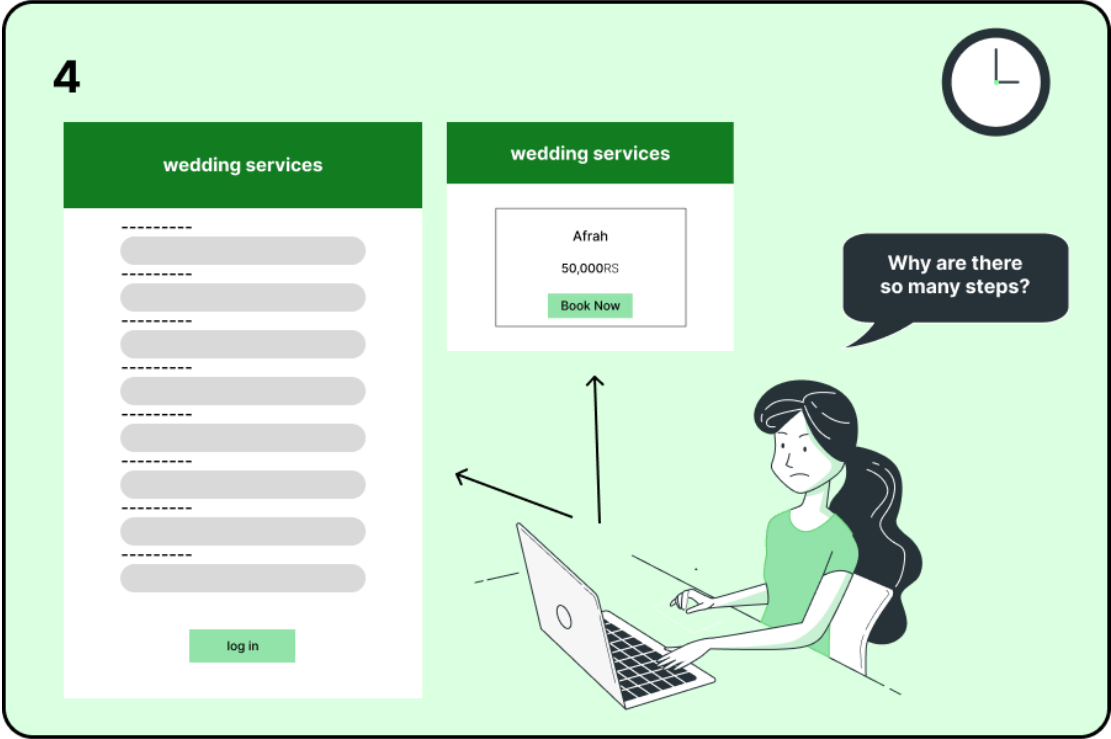
Action	Opens multiple service pages to check and compare prices and reviews.
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Emotion	Analytical but cautious due to hidden pricing and inconsistent information.
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Channel	Service detail pages and the (potential) side-by-side comparison tool.
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Figure 13. Storyboard Scene 3: Comparative Analysis and Pricing Ambiguity, illustrating the user's struggle with inconsistent pricing models and the necessity of a unified comparison tool within the Laylah platform..

Booking Decision



Element Description

Scene Where is the user located? (Place, time, environmental context)

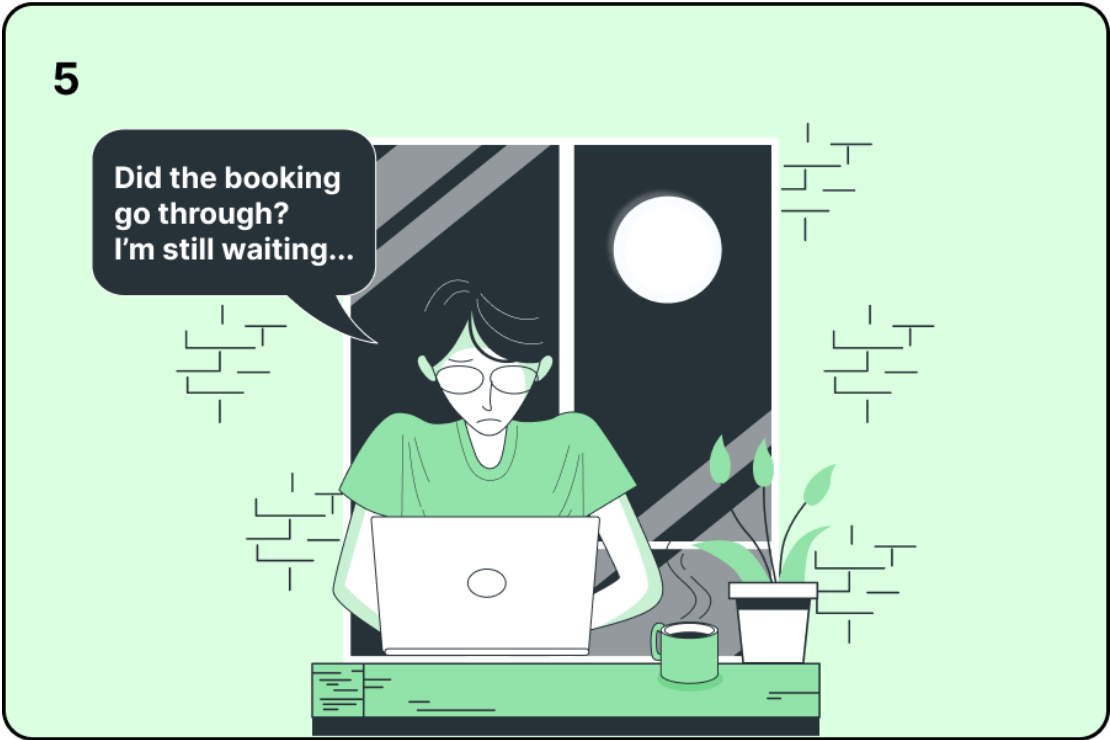
Action What is the user actually doing?

Emotion How is the user feeling at this moment? (Happy, frustrated, anxious)

Channel What tool/method is being used? (App, website, person, document)

Figure 14. Storyboard Scene 4: Process Complexity and Booking Friction, highlighting the user's frustration with traditional multi-step booking systems and the lack of a streamlined user journey before discovering the Laylah platform.

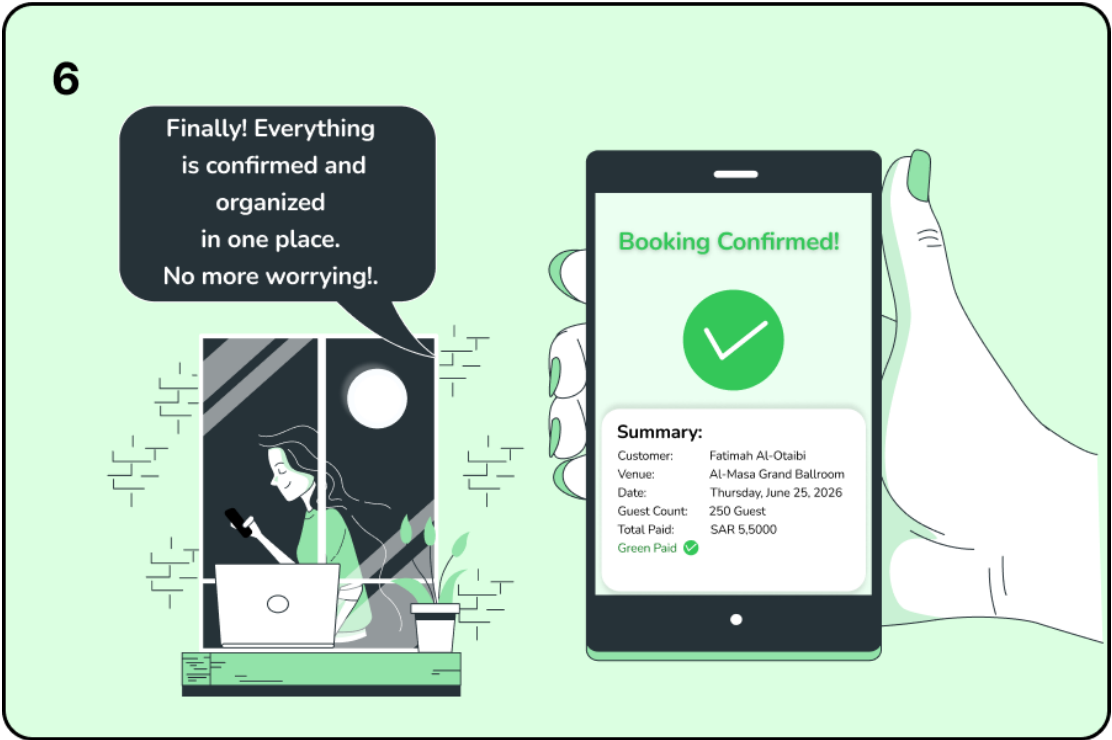
Waiting for Confirmation



Element	Description
Scene	Late at night at home, sitting by the window in a quiet environment.
Action	She keeps checking her laptop and notifications, waiting for a vendor's response or a confirmation email.
Emotion	Anxious and worried because of the delayed confirmation and lack of clear next steps.
Channel	Wedding planning platform via web browser.

Figure 15. Storyboard Scene 5: Post-Booking Anxiety and Confirmation Latency, depicting the user's emotional distress and uncertainty caused by delayed vendor responses and the lack of real-time status updates in traditional platforms.

Resolution (Opportunity)



Element	Description
Scene	Late at night at home, the atmosphere is now calm and positive.
Action	Fatimah views the "Booking Confirmed" screen on her mobile, showing a complete summary of the venue, date, and final price.
Emotion	Relieved, confident, and very happy because everything is clear with no hidden fees.
Channel	Mobile Application / Digital Booking Dashboard.

Figure 16. Waiting for Confirmation / Resolution (Opportunity) scene, presenting the user’s final steps and overall emotional outcome.

Storyboard					
	Stage	Scene	Action	Emotion	Channel
1	Entry / Landing	At her office desk during a break.	Fatimah enters the platform and immediately looks for the search bar to find wedding services.	Neutral but slightly impatient due to homepage clutter and unclear search visibility.	Wedding Planning Website.
2	Search & Filtering	Still at her desk, focusing intently on the laptop screen.	She applies specific filters like city, capacity, and budget to narrow down the results.	Frustrated because the filters are weak and showing inaccurate or irrelevant results.	The platform's filtering system or the search results page.
3	Comparison	Looking closely three different service pages side-by-side.	Opens multiple service pages to check and compare prices and reviews.	Analytical but cautious due to hidden pricing and inconsistent information.	Service detail pages and the (potential) side-by-side comparison tool.
4	Booking Decision	Where is the user located? (Place, time, environmental context)	What is the user actually doing?	How is the user feeling at this moment? (Happy, frustrated, anxious)	What tool/method is being used? (App, website, person, document)
5	Waiting for Confirmation	Late at night at home, sitting by the window in a quiet environment.	She keeps checking her laptop and notifications, waiting for a vendor's response or a confirmation email.	Anxious and worried because of the delayed confirmation and lack of clear next steps.	Wedding planning platform via web browser.
6	Resolution (Opportunity)	Late at night at home, the atmosphere is now calm and positive.	Fatimah views the "Booking Confirmed" screen on her mobile, showing a complete summary of the venue, date, and final price.	Relieved, confident, and very happy because everything is clear with no hidden fees.	Mobile Application / Digital Booking Dashboard.

Section 4 – Information Architecture & Task Modelling

System Structure & Organization

Laylah platform adopts a centralized marketplace structure designed to simplify the wedding planning process. The Information Architecture (IA) is goal-oriented rather than feature-oriented, meaning that navigation is structured around user intentions (search, compare, plan by budget) rather than listing services.

The structure was developed based on user research findings and identified behavioral patterns. It aims to:

- Reduce cognitive load
- Improve clarity of navigation
- Support efficient decision-making
- Provide multiple entry paths based on different user needs

The system is organized into clear top-level categories accessible from the homepage, allowing users to explore services, plan their budget, compare options, and manage bookings through a personalized dashboard. The structure reflects user behaviors identified in the journey map, supporting exploratory, budget-focused, decisive, and time-constrained users.

Sitemap

The following sitemap represents the hierarchical organization of the Laylah platform:

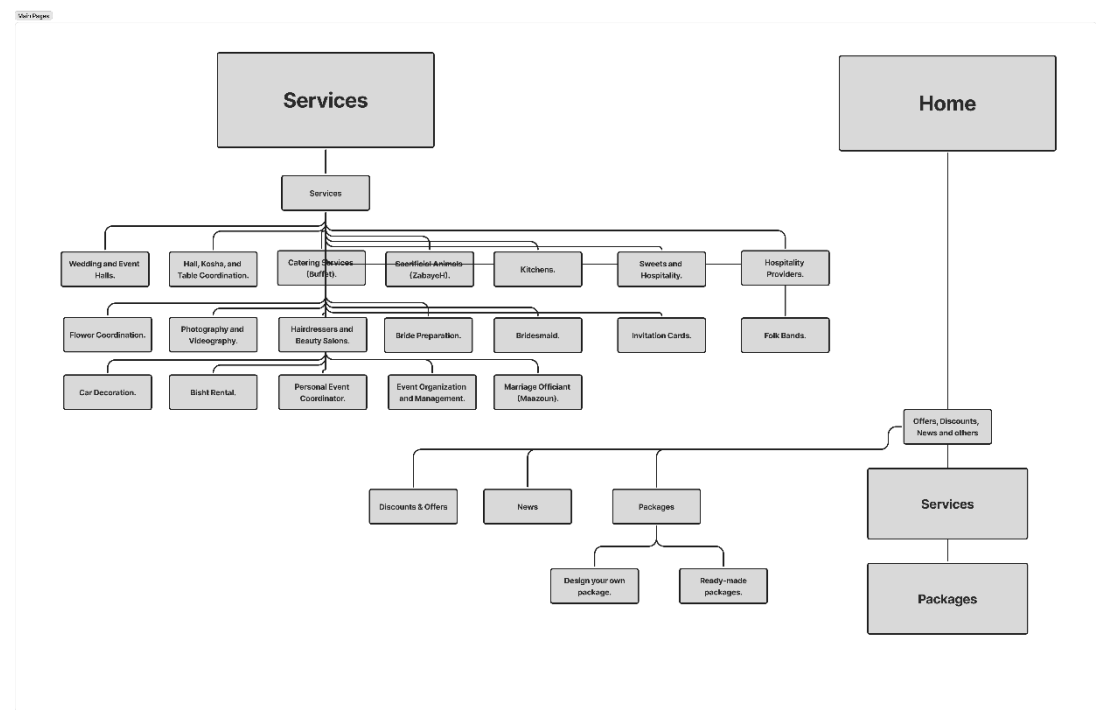


Figure 17. Main Landing Page and Service Ecosystem Information Architecture, illustrating the primary navigation hierarchy, service categorization, and the core entry points for packages and promotional content.

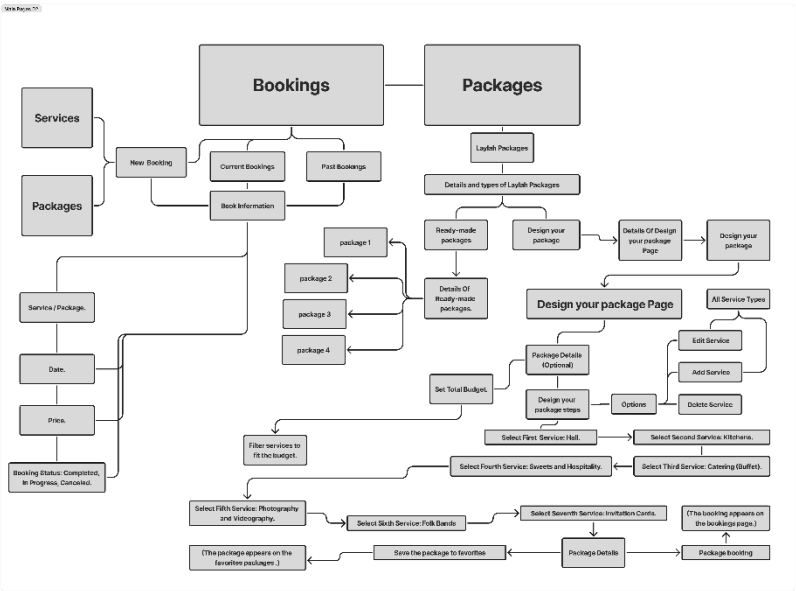


Figure 18. Information Architecture for Booking Management and Dynamic Packaging Logic, illustrating the hierarchical structure of user bookings and the sequential flow for creating customized service packages.

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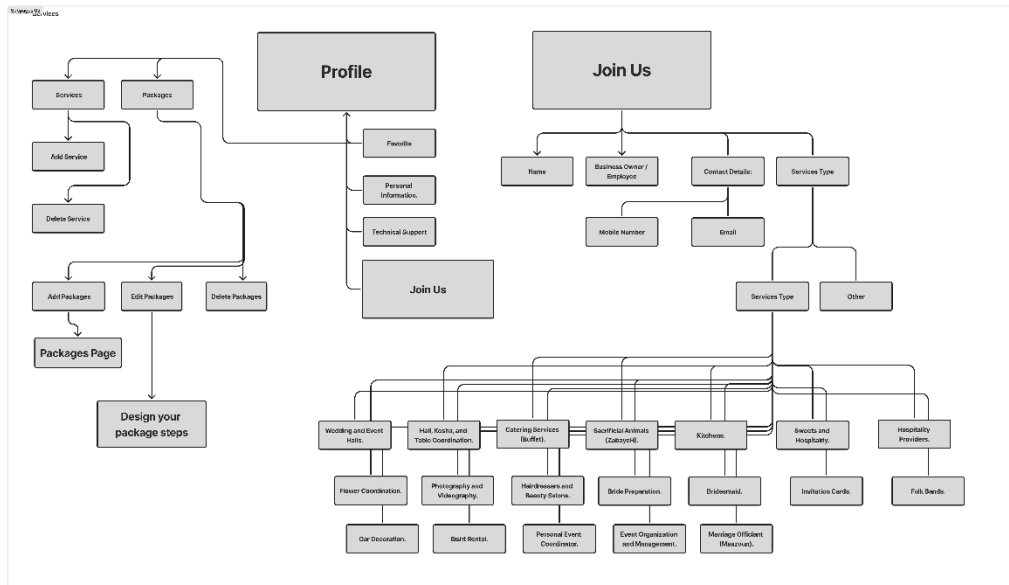


Figure 19. Information Architecture for User Profiles and Vendor Onboarding, detailing the hierarchical structure of the multi-step registration flow for service providers.

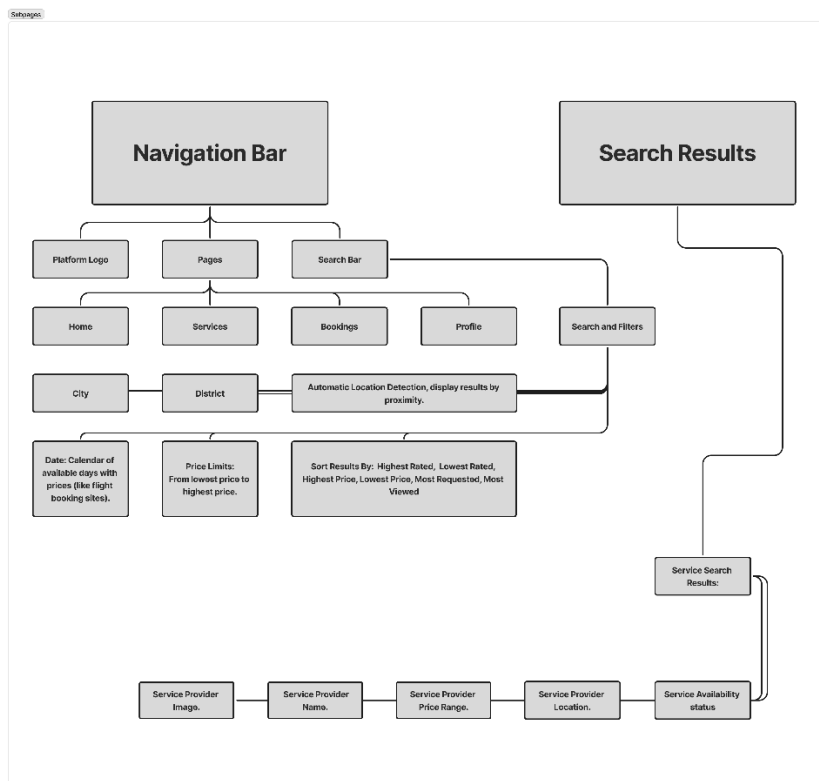


Figure 20. Navigation Framework and Search Logistics, illustrating the global navigation hierarchy and the granular filtering system for service discovery and results display.

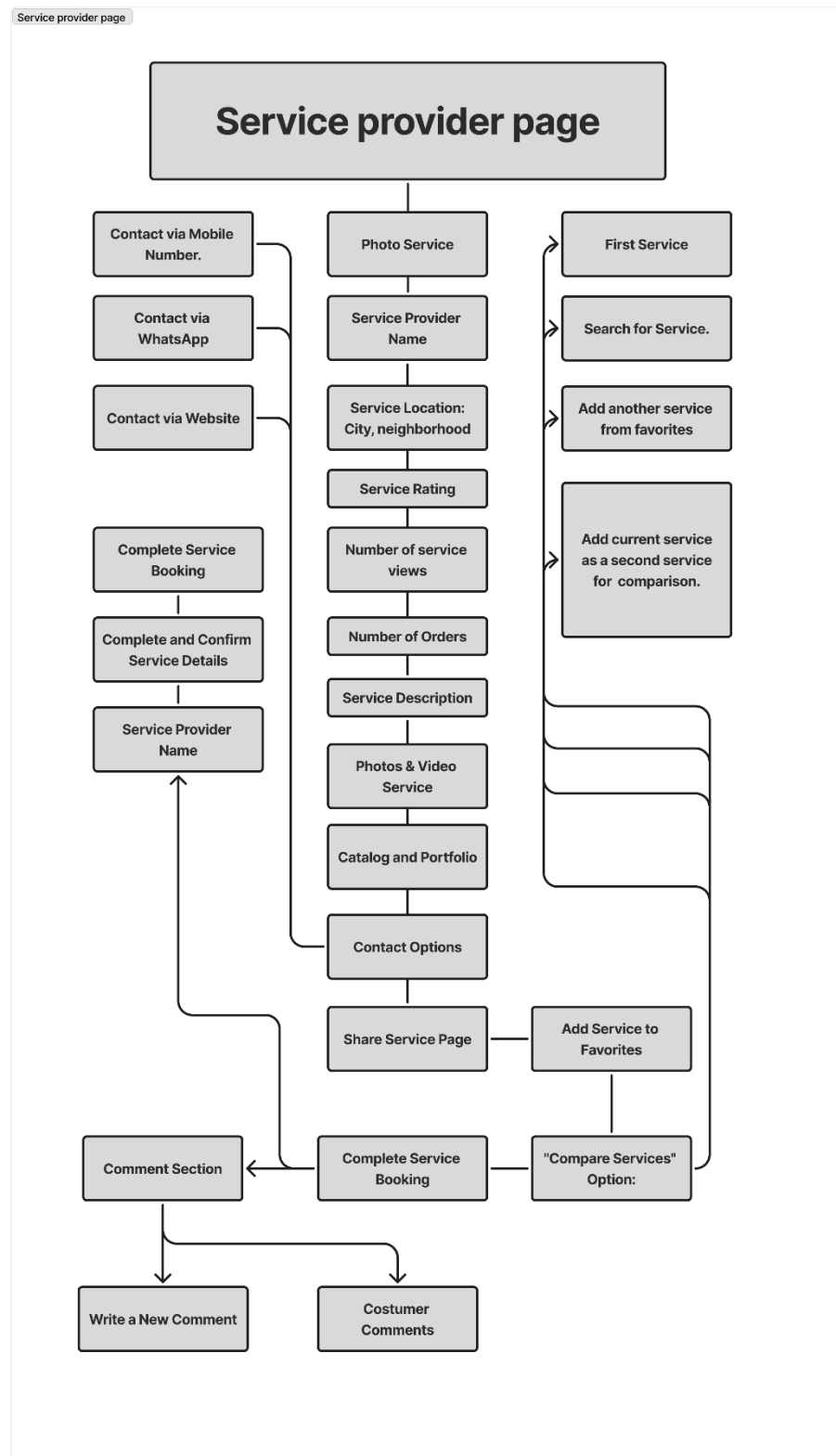


Figure 21. Service Provider Core Information Architecture, detailing the comprehensive data hierarchy, multi-channel contact infrastructure, and the decision-making toolkit for the users.

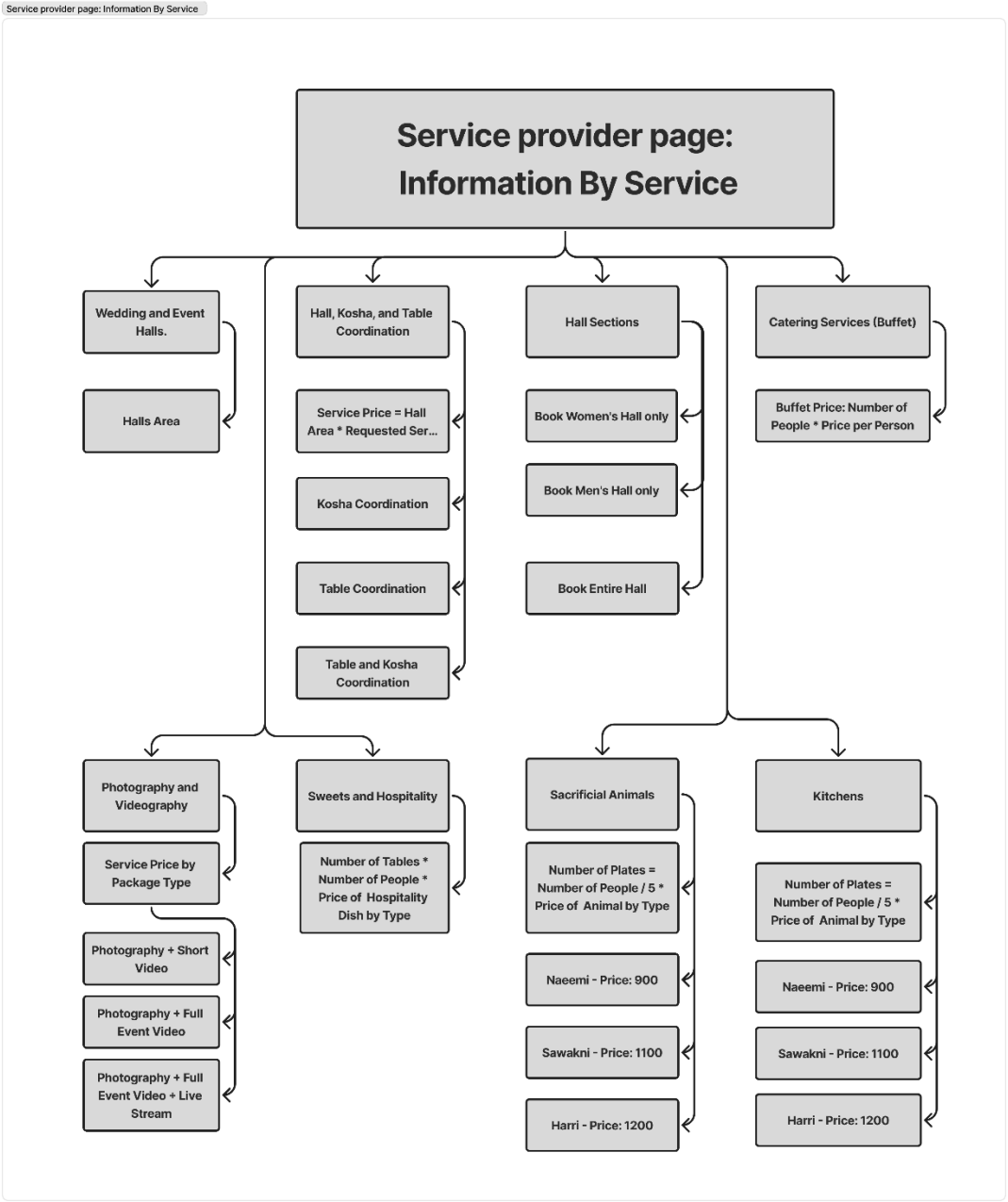


Figure 22. Service Provider Architecture and Dynamic Service Valuation Logic, detailing the granular information hierarchy for providers and the specific pricing formulas for services categories.

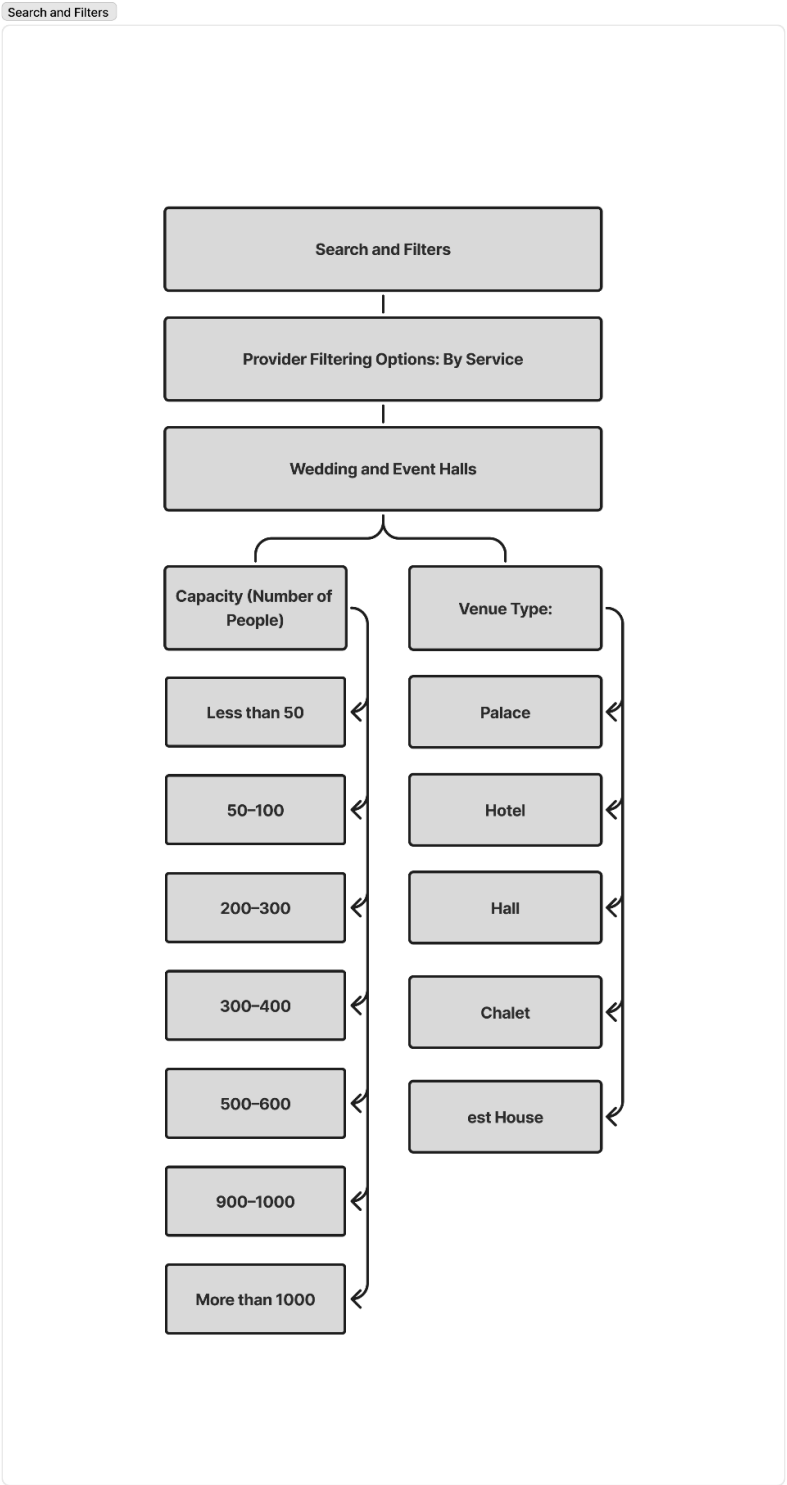


Figure 23. Advanced Filtering Taxonomy for Event Venues, showcasing the hierarchical categorization by Guest Capacity and Venue Type to streamline the user's discovery process.

Site Map (Laylah Platform)		
Main Pages	Home Page	Offers, Discounts, News, and others: • Offers and Discounts • News • Packages: ○ Design your own package. ○ Ready-made packages. Services: • Wedding and Event Halls. • Hall, Kosha, and Table Coordination. • Catering Services (Buffet). • Kitchens. • Sacrificial Animals (ZabayeH). • Sweets and Hospitality. • Hospitality Providers. • Flower Coordination. • Photography and Videography. • Hairdressers and Beauty Salons. • Bride Preparation. • Bridesmaid. • Invitation Cards. • Folk Bands. • Car Decoration. • Bisht Rental. • Personal Event Coordinator. • Event Organization and Management. • Marriage Officiant (Maazoun). Packages: ○ Design your own package. ○ Ready-made packages.
Main Pages	Services Page	Services: • Wedding and Event Halls. • Hall, Kosha, and Table Coordination. • Catering Services (Buffet). • Kitchens. • Sacrificial Animals (ZabayeH). • Sweets and Hospitality.

		• Hospitality Providers. • Flower Coordination. • Photography and Videography. • Hairdressers and Beauty Salons. • Bride Preparation. • Bridesmaid. • Invitation Cards. • Folk Bands. • Car Decoration. • Bisht Rental. • Personal Event Coordinator. • Event Organization and Management. • Marriage Officiant (Maazoun).
Main Pages	Packages Page	Laylah Packages • Details and types of Laylah Packages Ready-made packages: • package 1 • package 2 • package 3 • package 4 Design your own package: • Details Of Design your package Page • Design your package ○ Design your package Page
Subpage	Design your package Page	Package Details (Optional): • Set Total Budget. ○ Filter services to fit the budget. Design your package Steps • Options: ○ Edit Service: ▪ All Service Types ○ Add Service: ▪ All Service Types ○ Delete Service

		Select First Service: Hall. Select Second Service: Kitchens. Select Third Service: Catering (Buffet). Select Fourth Service: Sweets and Hospitality. Select Fifth Service: Photography and Videography. Select Sixth Service: Folk Bands Select Seventh Service: Invitation Cards. Package Details: • Package booking: ○ (The booking appears on the bookings page.) • Save the package to favorites: ○ (The package appears on the favorites packages .)
Main Pages	Bookings Page	• New Booking: ○ Services Page ○ Package Page • Current Booking: • Past Booking: • " Book Information": ○ Service / Package. ○ Date. ○ Price. ○ Booking Status: Completed, In Progress, Canceled.
Subpage	Profile Page	Favorite: • Packages ○ Add Packages: ▪ Packages Page ○ Edit Packages: ▪ Design your package steps ○ Delete Packages • Services ○ Add Service ○ Delete Service Personal Information Technical Support Join Us Page

Subpage	Join Us Page	Name Business Owner / Employee Contact Details: • Mobile Number • Email Services Type: • other • Services Type: ○ Wedding and Event Halls. ○ Hall, Kosha, and Table Coordination. ○ Catering Services (Buffet). ○ Kitchens. ○ Sacrificial Animals (ZabayeH). ○ Sweets and Hospitality. ○ Hospitality Providers. ○ Flower Coordination. ○ Photography and Videography. ○ Hairdressers and Beauty Salons. ○ Bride Preparation. ○ Bridesmaid. ○ Invitation Cards. ○ Folk Bands. ○ Car Decoration. ○ Bisht Rental. ○ Personal Event Coordinator. ○ Event Organization and Management. ○ Marriage Officiant (Maazoun).
Navigation Bar	Navigation Bar	Platform Logo Pages: • Home • Services • Packages • Bookings Search Bar: • Search and Filters

		○ City ○ District ○ Automatic Location Detection, display results by proximity. ○ Date: Calendar of available days with prices (like flight booking sites). ○ Price Limits: From lowest price to highest price. ○ Sort Results By: Highest Rated, Lowest Rated, Highest Price, Lowest Price, Most Requested, Most Viewed
Search and Filters	Search and Filters	Provider Filtering Options: By Service: ● Wedding and Event Halls: ○ Venue Type: ▪ Palace ▪ Hotel ▪ Hall ▪ Chalet ▪ Guest House ○ Capacity (Number of People): ▪ Less than 50 ▪ 50–100 ▪ 200–300 ▪ 300–400 ▪ 500–600 ▪ 900–1000 ▪ More than 1000
Search Results	Search Results	Service Search Results: ● Service Provider Image. ● Service Provider Name. ● Service Provider Price Range. ● Service Provider Location. ● Service Availability status
Inner Pages	Service provider page	Photo Service Service Provider Name Service Location: City, neighborhood

		Service Rating Number of service views Number of Orders Service Description Photos & Video Service Catalog and Portfolio Contact Options: • Contact via Mobile Number. • Contact via WhatsApp • Contact via Website Share Service Page Add Service to Favorites "Compare Services" Option: • First Service • Search for Service. • Add another service from favorites • Add current service as a second service for comparison. Complete Service Booking: • Service Provider Name • Complete and Confirm Service Details • Complete Service Booking Comment Section: • Write a New Comment • Costumer Comments
Inner Pages	Service provider page: Information By Service	Wedding and Event Halls: • Halls Area Hall, Kosha, and Table Coordination: • Service Price = Hall Area * Requested Service • Kosha Coordination • Table Coordination • Table and Kosha Coordination Hall Sections: • Book Women's Hall only • Book Men's Hall only • Book Entire Hall Catering Services (Buffet):

		• Buffet Price: Number of People * Price per Person Photography and Videography: • Service Price by Package Type: ○ Photography + Short Video ○ Photography + Full Event Video ○ Photography + Full Event Video + Live Stream Sweets and Hospitality: • Number of Tables * Number of People * Price of Hospitality Dish by Type Sacrificial Animals: • Number of Plates = Number of People / 5 * Price of Animal by Type • Naeemi - Price: 900 • Sawakni - Price: 1100 • Harri - Price: 1200 Kitchens: • Number of Plates = Number of People / 5 * Price of Animal by Type • Naeemi - Price: 900 • Sawakni - Price: 1100 • Harri - Price: 1200
--	--	--

- **Profile**
 - This hierarchical structure organizes services into clear categories and subcategories, making it easier for users to find information and move smoothly between sections.
- **Sitemap Link:**
 - (<https://www.figma.com/file/jaHgpwP5ferzdo2JTSp0mC?type=whiteboard>)

Navigation Flow

Laylah supports multiple navigation paths depending on user behavior:

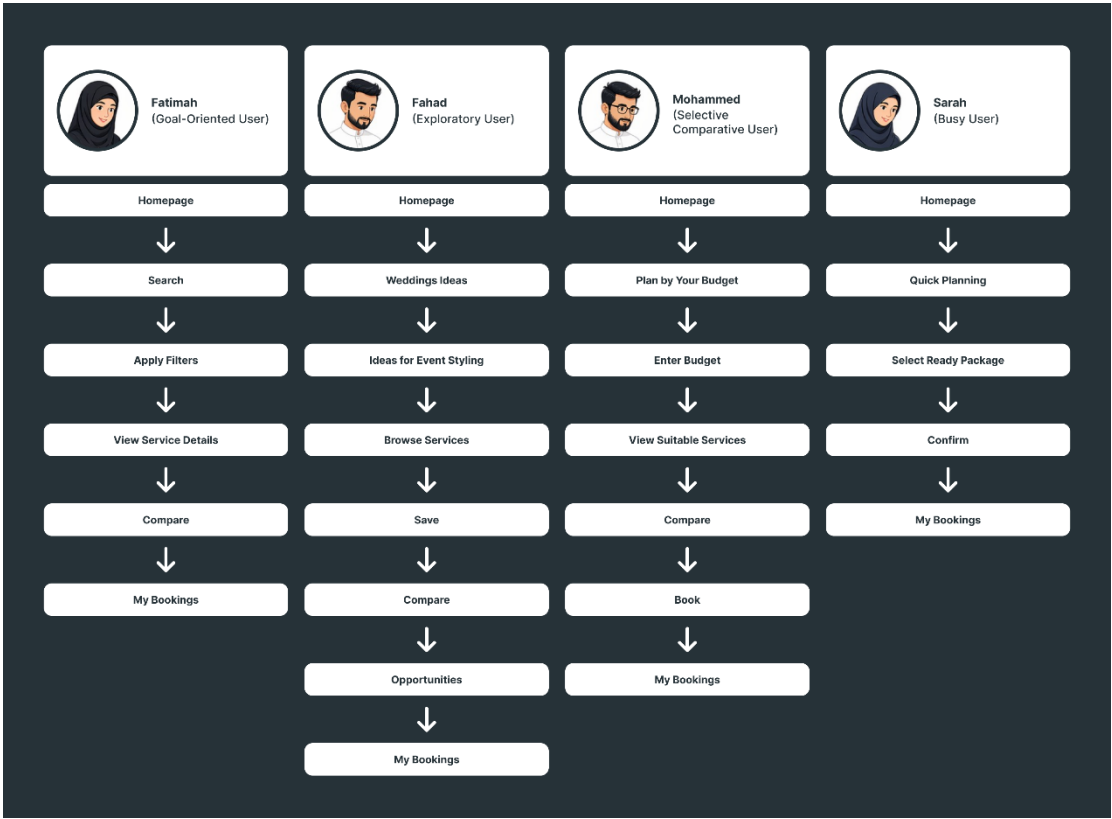


Figure 24. Comparative User Flow Analysis, mapping the four distinct personas (Fatimah, Fahad, Mohammed, and Sarah) to their specialized navigation paths to validate the platform's versatility.

Persona	Navigation Flow
Fatimah (Goal-Oriented User)	1. Homepage 2. Search 3. Apply Filters 4. View Service Details 5. Compare 6. Compare 7. My Bookings
Fahad (Exploratory User)	1. Homepage 2. Weddings Ideas 3. Ideas for Event Styling 4. Browse Services 5. Save 6. Compare 7. Opportunities 8. My Bookings
Mohammed (Selective Comparative User)	1. Homepage 2. Plan by Your Budget 3. Enter Budget 4. View Suitable Services 5. Compare 6. Book 7. My Bookings
Sarah (Busy User)	1. Homepage 2. Quick Planning 3. Select Ready Package 4. Confirm 5. My Bookings

Hierarchical Task Model (HTA)

The Hierarchical Task Analysis (HTA) illustrates how users achieve their main goal on the Layla platform: planning and booking wedding services efficiently. The model breaks down the overall goal into structured subgoals that reflect the logical user journey, from exploring services to completing bookings and managing expenses.

Overall Goal: Successfully Plan and Complete Wedding Service Bookings

Task Decomposition:

Goal / Subgoal	Task Description	Sequence / Relationship
0. Plan Wedding Services	Plan and book wedding services	Perform 1 → 2 → 3 → 4 → 5
1. Explore and Define Needs	Identify required wedding services	First stage
1.1 Wedding Services	Explore service categories	Start exploration
1.2 View service details	Review information and pricing	After browsing
1.3 Apply filters	Filter by (service, price, and location)	During browsing
2. Evaluate and Compare Options	Select and Compare Preferred Services	After defining needs

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Goal / Subgoal	Task Description	Sequence / Relationship
2.1 Save services	Add services to the saved list	Optional not required
2.2 Compare selected services	Compare Selected Services Side by Side	After saving Services
2.3 Review pricing details	Check cost breakdown	Before booking
3. Manage Budget	Monitor and control expenses	Before or during booking
3.1 Enter total budget	Enter Your Total Wedding Budget	Optional entry
3.2 Review expense summary	Check the total spent and the remaining amount	During planning
3.3 Adjust selections	Modify services if over budget	If Over Budget
4. Complete Booking	Confirm and finalize the reservation	After Comparing and Reviewing Services
4.1 Select service /package	Choose the final option	Required
4.2 Confirm details	Review booking summary	Before completion
4.3 Complete reservation	Finalize booking	End of transaction
5. Monitor and Manage Services	Manage bookings and saved services	After booking
5.1 View bookings	Check confirmed services	Post-booking
5.2 Monitor Spending and Remaining Budget	Monitor Total Spending and Remaining Budget	Throughout the Planning Process
5.3 Manage saved services	Edit or remove saved items	Optional not required

Section 5 – Methodology & Sprint Planning

- **Chosen Methodology:** Agile UX
- **Justification:**
 - We have adopted the Agile UX methodology for our wedding services platform to ensure a continuous cycle of design, testing, and refinement. Given the complexity of the wedding industry, this approach allows us to integrate insights from competitor benchmarking, user research, and stakeholder feedback in real-time. Instead of a linear process, we work in iterative loops: we analyze existing solutions, brainstorm features, and validate our Information Architecture (IA) through constant feedback. This ensures that our final design is not only functional but also evolves based on actual user needs and market standards, leading to a highly intuitive and user-centered wedding platform.
- **Chosen Design System:** Material Design
- **Justification:**
 - We chose Google's "Material Design 3" framework as the primary design reference for our platform to ensure maximum flexibility and consistency across different operating environments. Unlike more closed systems such as Apple's Human Interface Guidelines, this framework is specifically designed to support comprehensive cross-platform compatibility.

Sprint planning schedule				
Week	Sprint Goal	Tasks	Deliverables	Owner
1	Iterating on writing and revising project ideas	Propose project ideas that are relevant to our field and .feasible Discuss the project idea and agree on .its details	Nine proposed .project ideas Project idea and its main .details	Abdullah Saud Baraa Youssef Ghazi Zaid
2				
3	User research and competitor platform analysis	Collecting surveys and conducting user interviews Collecting and analyzing competitor platforms	Quantitative and qualitative data from surveys and interviews Competitor analysis data sheet	Youssef Saud Ghazi Abdullah Baraa Saud Ghazi
4				
5	Problem Statement, Objectives, Persona, Journey Map, and Storyboard	Writing the persona Writing and Designing the Journey Map Writing, Designing, and Drawing the Storyboard	Persona. Journey Map Storyboard	Youssef Abdullah Abdullah Ghazi Youssef
6				
7	Design the Information Architecture	Platform Information Architecture Design. Sitemap Design	Information Architecture of the Platform. Sitemap of the Platform.	Abdullah Youssef Youssef Abdullah Baraa
8				

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				Ghazi Saud
9	Choosing and developing a design system, and creating an interface prototype	Researching design systems and developing a system specific to the platform Reviewing and discussing the design system Designing a prototype of the platform interface Reviewing and developing the interface and its content	Platform design system Platform interface prototype	Baraa Youssef Baraa Youssef
10	Reviewing, developing, and presenting content	Creating visual representations of: (Persona, User Journey, User Flow) Developing, organizing, and structuring the sitemap	Visual Representations of: (Persona, User Journey, User Flow) Site Map	Youssef Saud Abdullah Youssef
11	High-fidelity Prototype (Stage 1)	High-fidelity prototype design for the platform's homepages Reviewing, content, and development of the high-fidelity prototype	High-fidelity prototype for the platform's homepages	Baraa Youssef

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12 - 13	High-fidelity Prototype (Stage 2)	Designing the website's subpages and internal pages Reviewing the High-fidelity Prototype with project members	High-fidelity prototype for Laylah platform	Baraa Youssef Baraa Youssef Ghazi Abdullah Saud Zaid
14	Usability Testing	Conducting a usability testing for the platform's high-fidelity prototype	Usability Evaluation Report for High-Fidelity Prototype	Youssef Ghazi

Team Timeline & Task Allocation

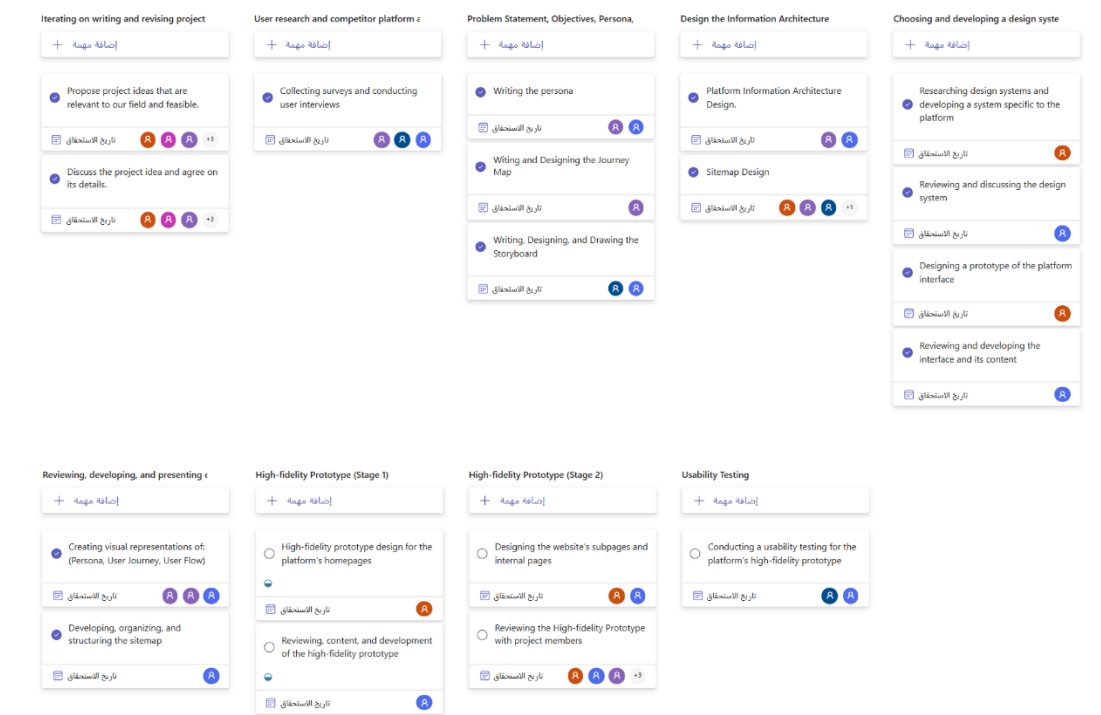


Figure 25. A project management board (Kanban style) developed via Microsoft Planner, illustrating the distribution of Stages, individual responsibilities through Week 14.



Figure 25. A detailed Project Gantt Chart illustrating the 14-week development timeline, mapping specific tasks to responsible team members and defining the sequential workflow from initial research to final usability testing.

Member Contribution Record for Graduation Project | Section (472) - Layla Platform:

- [\(Member Contribution Record For Graduation Project - Section \(6\) Layla Platform.xlsx\)](#)

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Week	Stage	Deliverables	Tools	Responsible Members	Member Name
1	Brainstorming ideas for the project	11 Ideas for Graduation Project	Microsoft Word	Ideas Lead	Youssef
2					
3	Research	Problem Statement, Objectives	Microsoft Word	Research Lead	Abdallah
4		Surveys, User Interviews	Google Form, Microsoft Excel	Research Sub-Lead	Youssef
		Research: Benchmarking	Microsoft Excel	Research Lead	Abdallah
5	Persona	Personas	Figma, Microsoft Word	Persona Lead	Youssef
6	Journey Map	Journey Map	Figma, Microsoft Word	Journey Map Lead	Abdallah
5	Storyboard	Storyboard	Figma	Storyboard Lead	Ghazi
7	Information Architecture: Site Map	Platform Site Map	Figma, Microsoft Word	AI Lead	Youssef
8	Information Architecture: Task Modelling		Microsoft Word	AI Sub-Lead	Abdallah
9	Prototype: Design system	Platform design system	Figma	AI Lead	Braa
10	Reviewing, developing, and presenting content	Visual Representations of: (Persona, User Journey, User Flow)	Figma, Microsoft Word	Main Lead	Youssef
		Visual Representations of: (Persona, User Journey, User Flow)	Figma	Sub-Lead	Saud
11	Design: Prototype	Platform Prototype	Figma, Visual Studio Code	UI Lead	Braa
12					
13					
14	Evaluation	Usability Evaluation Report		Testing Lead	Youssef